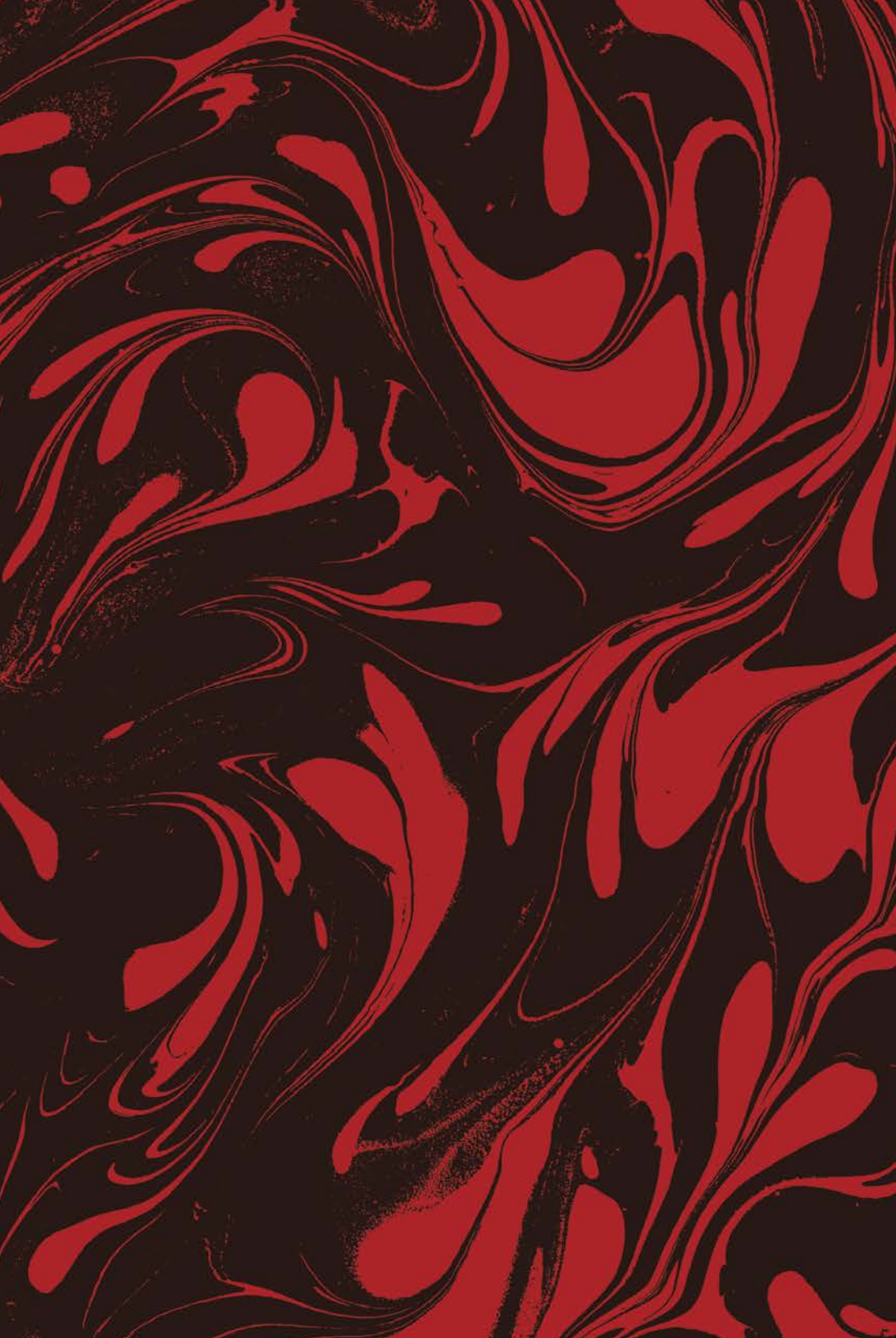
13 OMENS



PREVIEW

By Jason Bulmahn



PREVIEW

13 OMENS



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GAME DESIGN • Jason Bulmahn

ADDITIONAL DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT • Joe Pasini

ADDITIONAL DEVELOPMENT • Thurston Hillman, Erik Mona

ART DIRECTION & DESIGN • Adam Vick **EDIT LEAD** • Avi Kool

ARTISTS

Kent Hamilton, Simona Janikova, Mercal Mercado, Endi Oblak, Pixoloid Studios (Anna Petho, Janos Gardos, Peter Lerner), Adam Vick

PLAYTESTERS

Logan Bonner, Adam Daigle, Katina Davis, Rue Dickey, Cosmo Eisele, Eleanor Ferron, Ivis Flanagan, Thurston Hillman, James Jacobs, Jenny Jarzabski, Jason Keeley, Michelle Y. Kim, Mike Kimmel, Ron Lundeen, Erik Mona, Mark Moreland, Joe Pasini, Simone D. Sallé, Alex Speidel, Adam Vick, Costin Wilken-Schelling

Paizo Inc.

15902 Woodinville-Redmond Rd NE, Unit B Woodinville, WA 98072-4572

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Lost in the Dark

"I should have brought extra batteries." The tiniest tinge of panic cracked Luke's voice as Shandra slapped the flashlight against her palm, hoping that the light would stop flickering. The two had been in the Blackstone caves for well over two hours now, but the light had started to fail just a few minutes ago.

Shandra let out a grunt. The flashlight seemed to be working, for now. "I think we're lost. The site map said this was a one-hour excursion. Are you sure we're still in the main cave?"

Luke pulled out the map, and as he examined it, a worried expression darkened his face. "I don't know. I haven't seen any markers in a while. I think we should turn back." The two sat and stared at the map and the nearby caves for ten minutes before realizing that they were not entirely sure which way to go. The darkness seemed to be growing, closing in.

The flashlight was dying.

Picking a path, the pair scrambled forward at a frantic pace through the warm and humid condensation-slicked tunnel. They were practiced spelunkers, but in their haste, they both collected more than one scrape and bruise as they raced against their dying light source.

Without warning, Shandra lost her footing and fell to the ground, taking Luke down with her. They landed in a heap, crying out in pain. But as the echo died away and their breath steadied, they heard it. Something was moving out there in the dark, and they could hear rocks shifting and sliding in the distance. Far more troubling was the wet, squelching sound that accompanied the shuffling, echoing down the dark passageway.

Shandra held her breath and covered Luke's mouth just as he was about to speak. The sound seemed to be getting closer.



Pulling him near, she whispered in Luke's ear. "What the fuck is that?"

Luke's wide-eyed expression and subtle head shake told her he knew just as little as she did. He pointed in the opposite direction from the approaching sound. She nodded in return and quietly got up and started heading back, deeper into the caves.

At first, they tried to be quiet. But as the sound got closer, their pace became more hurried. When that did not slow its approach, they became reckless.

The light flickered as they bounded over rocks and ducked under flowstone overhangs. For a time, they ran through knee-deep water, freezing cold with a strange metallic scent. As soon as they left the water behind, they could make out the sound of splashing somewhere nearby. Whatever it was, it was right behind them.

Luke screamed, "GO!" in a panic as he scrambled up the edge from the water. Shandra scrambled up toward the only apparent exit from this chamber, a narrow crack in the wall. She held the flashlight behind her, hoping that Luke would be able to find his way to the opening.

As she wiggled into the fissure, the flashlight sputtered and died. Luke cried out in panic, but she had no choice but to go on.

"Oh, God." Luke spoke, his voice quiet and pleading. Shandra held her breath as terror griped her chest.

"Please, no."

A sick, wet crunching sound echoed from the dark.

Shandra squeezed forward, toward the dim light at the far end.



Introduction

There are things in this world that should not be, dark places that should not be explored, and secrets that should remain unknown. **13 Omens** is a horror roleplaying game that reveals these mysteries and asks you to experience the consequences faced by those who step into the darkness.

In 13 Omens, you take on one of two roles in telling a terrifying horror story. One player is the **Host**, who narrates the story, adjudicates the rules of play, calls for Checks, and metes out consequences. Everyone else at the table is a **player**, who takes on the role of a **character**: one of the protagonists of the story, desperately trying to survive the nightmare they find themselves trapped within.

Each game session is one complete **story** that includes a prologue and three **Acts**, the parts of the story that lead to a terrifying conclusion. Each story also contains several **Archetypes** used by the players to make their characters at the start of each session.

During play, whenever a character is in danger or their action is in doubt, that character's player draws between two and four six-sided dice from a bag that contains eight **Safe Dice** and one or more **Omen Dice**. At the start of play, there are 13 Omen Dice in front of the Host, but as the story progresses and the tension grows, the Host adds more Omen Dice to the bag. Drawing Omen Dice and rolling poorly on them leads to death and despair, so beware when reaching into the bag!

After three Acts of play, the characters have either vanquished the evil or have been overcome by its malevolence.

Preview

This is a preview of the 13 Omens game, containing the core rules and a story designed to be played in a single evening of horrifying fun. The full game is set to be released in early 2027, including the complete rules of play, guidelines on how to make your own stories, and several additional thrilling tales of terror. Interested in learning more? Visit **13Omens.com** to sign up for campaign alerts and to join the crowdfunder when it launches in October 2026!

Content Consideration

13 Omens is a horror roleplaying game dealing with mature topics that are worth talking about with your group before you start playing. Most stories in this game deal with common supernatural horror genre tropes such as blood, death, gore, hauntings, the occult, profanity, supernatural entities, suspense, violence, and the undead. Individual stories may note additional content considerations as well.

You should take the time to discuss the content of this game and the story you are playing with everyone at the table to ensure that your players are comfortable exploring these topics during the game. In some cases, challenging content can be toned down or even eliminated by the Host, but if it is central to the story, the best course of action is to find a different story to tell. Player comfort and safety come first.



GamePlay

13 Omens is a story-focused roleplaying game. The players describe their actions and speak for their character while interacting with each other and the Host, who plays the role of all the other characters and environments of the story. As the story unfolds, the characters perform various simple tasks without danger or difficulty; they automatically succeed at these. But when an action is dangerous or the outcome is uncertain, the Host may call for a **Check** of one of the character's **Aspects**, in which they roll dice to determine whether they succeed.

Each character is rated in ten different Aspects. Five of these are **Core Aspects** that are common to every game of 13 Omens. The five Core Aspects are printed below:

Story Aspects

In addition to these five Core Aspects, each character is also rated in five **Story Aspects**. These are specific to the individual story and are usually central to the characters and the plot of that narrative.

Aspect Ratings

A character's rating determines what **Target Number** (or TN for short) they need to roll to succeed at a task governed by that Aspect. For example, a character trying to flee from a knife-wielding killer might make an Evade Check to see if they get away unharmed. If their Evade rating is "Good," they would need to roll a 5 or higher to succeed.

Checks

Whenever a character attempts to do something where the outcome is in doubt or

Core Aspects

Courage	This measures a character's resolve, focus, and ability to resist temptation. You most often Check Courage when faced with something terrifying.
Evade	This Aspect rates a character's nimbleness and ability to avoid harm. You most often Check Evade when dodging an attack or unexpected danger.
Fight	Representing a character's strength and combat ability, this Aspect is also used to break down obstacles. You make Fight Checks to attack with a weapon and bash down doors.
Luck	Luck rates how fortunate a character might be. You might be asked to Check Luck when trying to find something that is lost or to see whether you have one more match left in the box.
Perception	Perception measures a character's ability to spot hidden dangers, notice unusual odors, or even detect a poisoned drink. You most often roll a Perception Check when trying to notice something that is not obvious.

the task is dangerous, the Host calls for a **Check** of one of the Aspects while also assigning a difficulty to that Check. The difficulty adjusts the Target Number that the player needs to roll to succeed at that Check. For example, a Hard task increases the difficulty by 1.

Making the Check

To make a Check, the player reaches into the dice bag and draws out two dice at random from all the dice in the bag. They then roll the dice and add the results together. If the number exceeds the TN, the attempt was a success. If it's equal to the TN, it's a success, but with some sort of small complication or setback. If it's less than the TN, it's a failure (page 10).

The Host typically describes the results of the Check, explaining how the character managed to succeed or what caused them to fail. Depending on the nature of the Check, there might be additional rewards, complications, or even injuries. After making a Check, all the dice are returned to the bag, with the possible exception of one Omen Die. See the Omen Dice section on page 8 for more details.

Edges

Sometimes a character might have the perfect tool for a task or have help from an outside source (including other characters). This is called an **Edge**. If a character has an Edge, they draw one extra die from the bag, then roll all the dice and add together **the two highest results** to determine the outcome of the attempt. Any Check can have up to two Edges, but they must come from different types of assistance (a good tool and outside aid would count, but multiple people helping would not). A player can decide to forgo drawing any additional dice from any Edges they have, but they must decide before drawing any dice from the bag.

Aspect Rating Table

Rating	Target Number
Terrible	10
Bad	9
Average	7
Good	5
Great	4

Task Difficulty

Difficulty	TN modifier
Very Easy	−2
Easy	−1
Average	+0
Hard	+1
Very Hard	+2

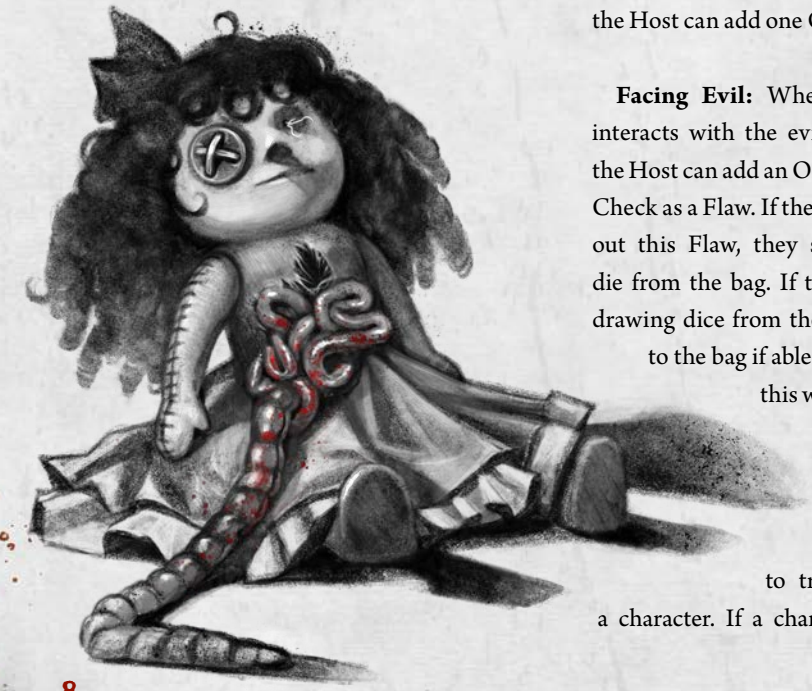


Flaws

In some cases, conditions or the environment might be working against the character, hindering their attempt. This is called a **Flaw**. If a character has a Flaw, they draw one extra die from the bag, then roll all the dice and add together **the two lowest results** to determine the outcome of the attempt. A Check can have up to two Flaws, but they also must come from different types of drawbacks (terrible weather and a broken tool would count, but a box full of broken tools still counts as only one). A player can't forgo drawing additional dice from the bag from any Flaws they have on a Check.

Canceling Out Edges and Flaws

If a character has both an Edge and a Flaw on a single roll, they cancel each other out, one for one, until either none are remaining or only Edges or Flaws remain. Any remaining Edges or Flaws are applied as normal.



Omen Dice

Whenever a character makes a Check, any Safe Dice drawn are rolled and returned to the bag without additional effects. Omen Dice are treated differently. Omen Dice represent the growing power of evil. Drawing them as part of a Check means that there is a sudden risk of serious harm to the character. These dice are typically red, but you can use any color if they are clearly different from the Safe Dice. At the start of each session, 13 Omen Dice sit in front of the Host, but as the story unfolds, more of these dice are added to the bag or directly to player Checks. The fewer Omen Dice there are in front of the Host, the more danger the characters face!

Omen Dice can be added to play in the following ways.

Story: When the events of the story take a turn for the worse and the power of evil grows, the Host can add one Omen Die to the bag.

Facing Evil: When a character directly interacts with the evil that surrounds them, the Host can add an Omen Die directly to their Check as a Flaw. If they have an Edge to cancel out this Flaw, they simply draw one fewer die from the bag. If they gain the Edge after drawing dice from the bag, return a Safe Die to the bag if able. An Omen Die added in this way must be rolled as part of the Check.

Character Death: Omen Dice are used to track the harm done to a character. If a character dies or otherwise

succumbs to the evil, all Omen Dice in front of them are returned to the bag.

Wounds

Omen Dice are rolled just like any other die and and are used to calculate the outcome of a Check. However, Omen Dice also determine whether the character was harmed in the process. If the result of any Omen Dice is equal to or less than the current Act of the story (for example, an Omen Die result is 2 or lower during Act 2), after the Check is resolved, one of the Omen Dice is removed from play and placed in front of the character who rolled it. This is called a **Wound**. This represents some form of harm, as befitting the narrative. It might be physical or psychological in nature, but it should make sense for whatever was being attempted. Omen Dice whose results are greater than the Act of the story are returned to the bag along with the Safe Dice.

A character can never receive more than one Wound from the result of a Check, even if multiple Omen Dice are rolled and would result in a Wound (excess Omen Dice of this type are returned to the bag). An Omen Die can still result in a Wound even if that die isn't used as part of the result due to there being more than two dice rolled (typically due to an Edge or Flaw).

Once a character has three Omen Dice in front of them, they're seriously hurt or reaching the depths of despair and take a Flaw on all Checks. This Flaw counts as a different source from all other Flaws (including those caused by a Strain, explained on page 11). This can be canceled out by an Edge as normal.

Cheating Death

At any time, when a character would place an Omen Die in front of themself, they can instead place a Safe Die. This doesn't count toward death and despair (but it does remove that die from the bag, making it more likely that others draw Omen Dice). A character cannot cheat death if their roll did not include any Safe Dice.

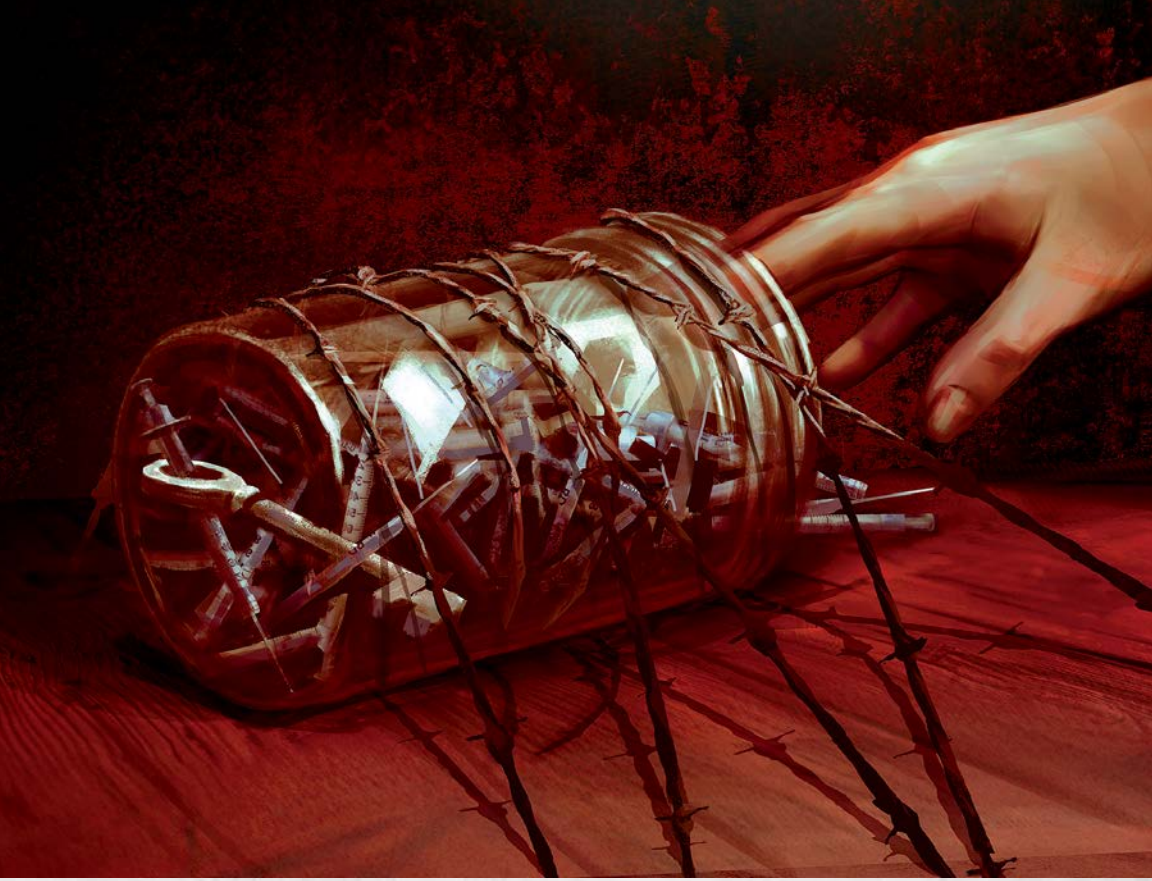
This can be done only once per Act, and no character can Cheat Death more than once in a story.

Valiant Sacrifice

If a player has three Omen Dice in front of them and they draw one or more Omen Dice as part of a Check, they can declare that they intend to valiantly sacrifice their character for the sake of the others. In this case, they don't roll the dice, and instead they automatically succeed at the Check, but in doing so, their character suffers some final terrible wound and is removed from play. All their Omen Dice and the dice drawn as part of the roll are returned to the bag.

Death and Despair

Whenever a player has a fourth Omen Die in front of them, their character succumbs to their wounds or falls into despair. That character can no longer participate in the story, and all the dice in front of them are returned to the bag. In some stories, the player can resume play by taking on the role of another character. If all the characters perish in this way, evil is triumphant, and the story draws to a close.



The Host typically describes the way in which a character perishes, but in the case of a valiant sacrifice, the player can detail the way in which their character dies or is removed from play.

Failed Checks

Failing a Check is always accompanied by some sort of cost or drawback. Most often this is simply a failure to accomplish a specific objective, like opening a stuck door or translating an ancient piece of text. Other times it might just result in a lost opportunity, failure to acquire a useful tool, or a lack of knowledge. In some rare cases, the Host might decide that you succeeded at your attempted task anyway, but that you suffered some other drawback instead. Often this happens in a Risky Check.

Risky Checks

Some Checks carry an inherent risk of danger or injury, like trying to jump across a chasm or attempting to wrestle a knife from a killer's grasp. The Host can, at their discretion, declare a Check to be **Risky**, meaning that failure carries additional consequences. If the character fails a Risky Check, they suffer some sort of drawback. This is most typically a Strain to one Aspect or the loss of a piece of Gear, likely due to it being lost or broken.

If a piece of Gear is lost or broken, the Host selects a piece of Gear that makes sense based on the circumstances. It might be possible to repair this item or find it later, but this isn't guaranteed.

Strain

Characters in 13 Omens can be harmed in many ways. While serious injuries and death come from Omen Dice, lesser wounds that result from failed Risky Checks often result in **Strain**. If your character takes a Strain, the Host describes an injury or trauma and assigns it to one of the character's Aspects. Whenever the character makes a Check using that Aspect, they take a Flaw. Examples of a Strain are a sprained ankle, twisted back, double vision due to a blow to the head, a run of bad luck, or even just a creeping sense of doubt. Alternatively, a Strain might cause the loss of one Perk (page 14), especially if it was utilized as part of the failed risky roll.

A character might go to great lengths to alleviate a Strain using other Aspects or Gear (such as bandaging a sprained ankle or taking a powerful painkiller for a twisted back). No more than one Strain can be removed in this way at a time, and if the character ever fails another Check using that Aspect, their Strain returns. A character can gain both a Strain and a Wound as part of the same Check, if the roll includes one or more Omen Dice.

Harmless Checks

Sometimes a Check doesn't pose any possible risk of injury or trauma. In such cases, the only real price for failure is usually a lack of awareness, incorrect knowledge, or a missed opportunity. The Host can declare such Checks to be **Harmless**, meaning that even if an Omen Die is drawn as part of the roll, it can't result in a Wound. If the Omen Die result is equal to or less than the current Act, instead of taking a Wound and placing the Omen Die in front of them, the character instead takes a Strain to the Aspect in question and returns the Omen Die to the bag. Harmless rolls typically only occur in Act One or Act Two. By Act Three, the danger should be so great that failing most Checks likely carries a deadly risk.

Players Always Roll

The players are the ones who roll to determine the outcome of events and actions that affect their characters. If the Host is forced to decide how an event plays out, they simply decide the outcome without rolling, but this should never affect a player's character directly. For example, if a ghost is chasing a character through the house trying to possess them, the player should roll an Evade Check to see if they can hide from it or a Courage Check to resist its influence. If, instead, the ghost is trying to possess a nonplayer character, the Host decides whether it is successful without rolling, describing the events as they occur.

Creating a Character

Characters for each story are made as part of the session. Every story opens with a brief introduction to give you a sense of who the characters are and what they are doing just before the events of the story begin. Next, the Host reads a simple synopsis of each of the **Archetypes** present in the story. Think of these as character profiles that describe relevant details about the character in broad, sweeping strokes. It is from these Archetypes that the players create their specific character.



For example, if the story revolves around a group of college students who get lost in the woods during a camping trip, the Archetypes might be the Athlete, the Fraternity Pledge, the Math Scholar, the Musician, and the Teacher's Assistant. The player who plays the Musician might then make a character who is a wannabe pop sensation, or they might be someone hoping to be in an orchestra, with both being valid expressions of the Archetype.

Once you have selected an Archetype, you rate your Aspects, select perks, and choose some Gear. Once that is done, all you need to do is settle on a name, appearance, and any other details needed to round out your character.

Archetypes

All stories in 13 Omens feature several character Archetypes that are relevant to the specific story. Each player selects one of these Archetypes to form the basis of their character. Archetypes start off with a detailed description of their purpose and role in the story, followed up by suggested personality traits and opinions on the other characters (based on the Archetypes), and a personal goal for the character to strive toward during the story. In addition, each Archetype has its own custom list of Perks and Gear to choose from.

Flexible Personality

The personality traits and opinions listed on each Archetype are flexible. You should feel free to change these or take the character in a different direction if your idea doesn't align with these suggestions. Note that other characters may have opinions about your character based on these suggestions, so if you make any significant alterations, you should inform the other players so they can formulate their own opinions about your character accordingly. The personality of your character is ultimately up to you to decide.

Goals

The goal listed on each Archetype gives your character a hook into the story, or it can provide something active for your character to attempt that's perhaps beyond the scope of the story's central conceit. There is no reward for accomplishing your goal, nor is there a penalty for failing to reach it. The point is to give your character a personal motivation. You can, of course, select an entirely different goal, if it fits within the narrative of the story.

Aspects

After selecting an Archetype and reading the description and personality tips, the next step is assigning a rating to each of the character's Aspects. First are five Core Aspects: Courage, Evade, Fight, Luck, and Perception. These are common to all 13 Omens characters (see page 6 for a description of each Core Aspect). This is followed by five Story Aspects, which are custom to each 13 Omens story. Story Aspects are directly related to the Archetypes in each story, and each Archetype is rated great in one of these Aspects to reflect their role in the story.

Aspect Rating Table

Rating	Target Number
Terrible	10
Bad	9
Average	7
Good	5
Great	4

The first step is to rate your character's aptitude in each of the five Core Aspects. The ratings are terrible, bad, average, good, and great. You must use each rating once when rating the Core Aspects. The next step is to repeat this process with the Story Aspects, but note that one Aspect is already rated great by the Archetype, meaning that you must rate the others terrible, bad, average, and good, using each rating once.

When you are finished, you should have ratings for all ten Aspects, and each different rating should appear twice (one time in each Aspect group).

Each rating is associated with a Target Number (or TN for short), as described in the Aspect Rating Table above. Whenever your character attempts an Average task involving that Aspect, this TN is what they must roll equal to or greater than to succeed. Record the Target Number next to the rating for ease of reference.

Perks

Each Archetype includes a variety of custom **Perks** to flesh out the character, giving them some special way to interact with the rules of the game. Carefully read through all the Perks before selecting two of them to give to your character. Note that most Perks can be used only during a specific circumstance or a have a limit on the usage. If a Perk says it can be used only once per Act and you don't use it during an Act, that usage is lost. It can't be saved for later. In addition, if a Perk grants an Edge or removes a Flaw from a Check and you don't notice it until after the roll is made, the Perk cannot modify the result. Likewise, if you draw dice from the bag and then notice a Perk that removes a Flaw, you can return a die to the bag, but it can't be an Omen Die if one was already drawn. Such are the cruel whims of fate.

Diversity in Perks

Archetypes often include one or more Perks that speak to similar parts of the game, like the ability to ignore or remove a Strain or advantages when your character is involved in a fight. While it might be tempting to focus on these Perks if they fit the character's concept, consider diversifying your Perk selections to other facets of the game. That way you can expand the story of your character and explore why they might have other abilities as well.

Gear

After picking Perks, review the list of Gear options provided with each Archetype. Gear that is vital to the story is given automatically, but each character gets several discretionary choices as well. In most cases, each character can take up to four items from this list (although some Archetypes might give a different number, and some Perks might allow for additional choices).

Gear is most often used during play to award a character an Edge when attempting a Check, based on having the right tool for the task at hand. Breaking down a door might be hard, but a character with a crowbar, for example, would certainly have an easier time accomplishing the task. When selecting the Gear for your character, think about how it might be used during play, but don't be afraid to take something that just sounds fun for the character you have in mind. You never know when the strangest of items might save your character's life.

Finishing Touches

Once you have rated your Aspects, chosen Perks, and selected your Gear, the only steps left to finish your character are to give them a name, jot down a basic description of what they look like, and get a feel for how you think their personality plays out during the story. Feel free to make small adjustments to these notes as the game goes on. 13 Omens is a game about desperate people in terrifying situations trying to survive. Characters thrust into such situations are likely to react unpredictably at times, especially when their lives are in danger.

Once all the characters are made, the story begins with the Host reading the prologue.

Sample Build

OFFICE WORKER

It's not that you hate your job, you just hate going to it every day with no end in sight. Waking up at 6 a.m. for the morning commute through heavy traffic certainly does not help your mood any. The worst part is just how anonymous it all is. The strangers on the subway can be excused, but yesterday was your birthday and not a single person at the office seemed to remember. You always knew life as a coder would not be the most exciting, but this is a level of dullness you never thought you would experience. Who knows, maybe one day, something exciting will finally happen? Doesn't hurt to dream.



GOAL: You are desperately looking to add some excitement to your life and are more than willing to take some unnecessary risks to make it happen.

Possible Personality Traits: Choose from among the traits on this list or add your own: *Bored, Depressed, Eager, Excitable, Friendly, Intellectual, Isolated, Lonely, Lost, Melancholy, Tired*

Relations to Other Characters: These are just some suggestions about how you feel about the other characters.

Construction Worker: You thought they were pretty surly at first, when you woke up in this place, but behind that gruff exterior, they genuinely seem like an honest, friendly person.

Subway Busker: You gave them some spare change when you got on the subway and now, they seem to think you are their best friend. At least they are pretty good with that instrument, but you are not sure that is going to help you get out of here.

Tired Parent: They have not said a word since you got here and that's more than a little suspicious. They seem fixated on a stuffed animal, and it is just giving you bad vibes.

The Tourist: Clearly not from around here. They spent the entire time on the subway taking photos, but since they woke up, they just looked shocked. This is definitely not a side of the city they wanted to see.

2

5 **NAME:** Camila Rodriguez
TRAITS:

1

CORE ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Courage	Bad	9	☐
Brade	Good	5	☐
Fight	Terrible	10	☐
Luck	Average	7	☐
Perception	Great	4	☐

2

STORY ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Computers	Great	4	☐
Construction	Terrible	10	☐
Medicine	Average	7	☐
Performance	Bad	9	☐
Trivia	Good	5	☐

3 **PERKS**

Choose any two of the following Perks.

☐ **Code Wizard:** You have a way with code. Once per Act, you can add an Edge to any one Computers Check you make to alter code or override system security.

☒ **Cube Dweller:** You are used to working in confined spaces with little to no sunlight. You do not take a Flaw on Checks due to cramped spaces or a lack of light.

☐ **Just Bored:** Life has just been kind of dull for you and you are ready for excitement. Once per story, when you are making an exciting Check, cancel any Flaws and add an Edge.

☐ **Late for Work:** You don't know why anyone would bother to kidnap you, but one thing is certain. This is going to make you late for work. Once per story, you can complain about how late you are to remove a Strain.

☒ **Messenger Bag:** You manage to cram a lot of items into that bag you carry. You start with up to six items from the list of possible gear. In addition, you can add any one item to the list as long as it is small enough to fit in the bag.

☐ **Very Tired:** You are used to being tired, and whatever drugs they used on you do not seem to be affecting you like the others. You do not take a Flaw on Checks in Act One.

4 **GEAR**

Your character starts with a Messenger Bag, Laptop, Cell Phone, and up to four selections from the following list: *Apple, Coding Magazine, Comb, Energy Drink, Job Application, Nail File, Notebook and Pen, Pack of Chewing Gum, Roll of Quarters, Sandwich, Scissors, Stack of Sticky Notes*

Apple, Energy Drink, Nail File, Pocket Knife, Roll of Quarters, Sandwich, Scissors

3

Joe is playing a game of 13 Omens with some friends that involves their characters getting abducted while riding a subway and being forced to play a series of deadly games. After listening to the Archetype summaries, Joe decides to play the Office Worker. After reading through the text, Joe wants to create a burnt-out coder, desperate for a change in her life.

Step 1: Joe starts by assigning ratings to the Core Aspects. Joe wants his character to be perceptive and agile, but not much of a fighter.

Step 2: Next up are the Story Aspects. Computers is already rated great, so Joe assigns the other four ratings to the Aspects, deciding to be good at trivia.

Step 3: Next, Joe gets to pick two Perks for his character. Joe picks Cube Dweller and Messenger Bag, both of which sound like they are going to be useful in this story.

Step 4: Joe gets to pick six pieces of gear thanks to the Messenger Bag perk and adds one item not on the list. Joe thinks a pocket knife might come in handy.

Step 5: After deciding on a name and personality, Camila Rodriquez is ready to play.


EXIT

Hosting a Story

The Host sits at the center of each 13 Omens story, narrating the events as they unfold. More than just an arbiter of the rules, the Host works to weave the characters' actions together in each scene, forming an ongoing tale of terror and dread. The Host makes sure the story stays on track and ensures that the pace and tension match the expectation of the plot. Finally, the Host adjusts the story and adapts its scenes if the direction of the game strays from the exact details laid out in the story. Improvisation is important in making sure the players have agency while also guiding the story to a satisfying conclusion.

Since the Host never rolls dice, the primary way that they interact with the players and their characters is by calling for Checks and adjudicating the results. This is critical in determining the shape of the story and the fate of its characters, and as such it is covered in some detail in the following pages. The Host also controls the pace of the story, primarily through Omen Dice, deciding when to add them to rolls and to the bag, increasing the overall danger that the characters face.

Most 13 Omens stories deal with horrifying villains and evil supernatural foes. The Host controls these monsters and their actions, but in this role, the Host is not an adversary of the players. Their role is to portray these creatures, to decide how they act and to describe the ways in which they menace the characters. This is all in service of creating a good, scary tale, not to foil the fun of the players portraying those characters. Some characters will die during these stories, but their players should never be made to feel that the Host is actively working against them.

Content Considerations

13 Omens is a modern supernatural horror game and as such, it frequently deals with difficult topics and terrifying content. While this is generally part of the fun of telling a good horror story, care should be taken to make sure that all the players know what they are about to play. That doesn't mean the story should be spoiled, but an honest discussion about the content with the group allows the Host to adjust the story as needed to avoid making anyone uncomfortable.

Finally, stories can sometimes take unexpected turns into content that no one saw coming. Consider using simple safety tools to allow players to signal the host and stop the story if it takes too dark a turn or if folks need a break from the tension.

An open line of dialogue between players after the game allows everyone to express their thoughts about how things went without interrupting the flow of the story. It also allows the Host to make adjustments for next time.

Telling a Story

Each game of 13 Omens is one complete story meant to be played in a single sitting. Before play begins, the Host should review the story they are planning to play, making sure to read the overall structure and to familiarize themselves with the individual scenes that make up the tale. They should also note any content that merits discussion with the group beforehand to allow time for alterations.

Although each individual story for 13 Omens has its own plot, antagonists, character Archetypes, and setting, there are several common horror story techniques that are worth keeping in mind when telling a story.

Terror Builds Slowly: Give the players time to experience their characters and inhabit their perspective before the evil that awaits them makes itself known. This sets a baseline for what's to follow, but don't forget to include hints or signs of what's to come.

Less is More: The most horrifying things are rarely fully described, especially early in the story. Letting a player's imagination fill in the details is often far scarier than anything the story could offer up.

Twists and Revelations: Aside from a false start or two, most horror stories feature some central plot twist or revelation that helps transition the story from the normal world to one of terror and suspense. Identifying this central moment and emphasizing it is critical to the pacing of the story.

Hope is Key: The players must have hope that their characters might somehow survive. Without a chance of escape, it's easy to view the situation as unwinnable, which leads to unrealistic choices or foolish sacrifices. Hope should be snuffed out only at the last moment of a character's life.

Story Structure

Each 13 Omens story follows a similar structure, meant to make it easy for the Host to move between scenes and to alter the story as it unfolds in response to character actions. Stories contain the following sections.

Synopsis and Content Considerations: Each story starts off with a plot synopsis for the Host. This details the shape of the tale before presenting the individual scenes that make up the bulk of the story. A brief look at any content considerations the story might contain to talk over with the group follows the synopsis.

Introduction and Archetypes: Each story contains a brief introduction for the Host to read to the players. This introduction provides a basic sense of how the story begins. This is followed up by a summary of each of the Archetypes present in the story. Taken together, this context gives the players all the information they need to select an Archetype and make their character for the story.

Prologue: Once all the players select and create their characters, the next part of the story is the prologue. The Host should read this text to the players to fully set the stage and get the



players in the mood of the story. The prologue doesn't include the players' characters in the action but is instead some legend or event that occurs before the actual story unfolds.

Acts: After the prologue, the bulk of the story is divided up into three Acts, each of which serves an important role in the story. In Act One, the players are not yet fully aware of the danger. They are getting to know each other and their environment. At the start of Act Two, the evil reveals itself, usually by striking out at the characters directly. From this point onward, the power of the evil grows. Finally, in Act Three, the characters face the evil. Perhaps they vanquish it or escape from its clutches, but they might succumb to their fates.

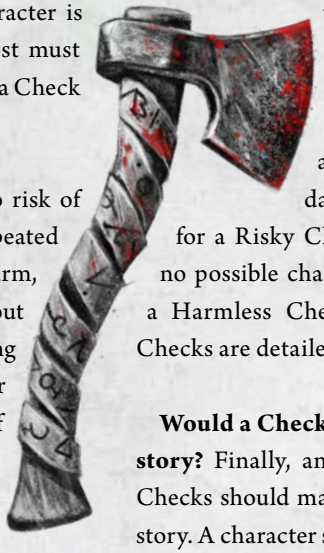
Scenes: Each Act is broken down into several scenes. These scenes represent discrete moments in the story that move the plot forward in some important way. Scenes are often location based, but they can also be based on time or triggered by other events. Scenes contain a variety of Checks and might offer the Host specific opportunities to add Omen Dice.

Conclusion: Each story ends with guidance for how to conclude the tale based on how the events played out. Typically, this includes an ending that assumes one or more characters succeed at defeating the evil or surviving the threat, and an ending in which the characters fail and meet their demise—such is the fate of many who face 13 Omens.

Calling for Checks

The Host's major responsibilities during a story are to narrate the setting, describe the actions of nonplayer characters, and to adjudicate the characters' actions. Whenever a player describes what their character is attempting to accomplish, the Host must decide whether that action calls for a Check to determine success.

In most cases, when there is no risk of failure, few consequences for repeated attempts, and no real chance of harm, the action simply succeeds without a Check. Opening a door, moving a chair, reading a book, and other basic tasks are all good examples of actions that typically don't require a Check.



When to Ask for a Check

Even a normally simple or routine task can call for a Check if the circumstances are extraordinary or dangerous. Opening a door might be routine at the post office, but pulling open a door in an abandoned factory while being chased by a killer might call for a Check. The Host should weigh the following before asking a character to make a Check.

Is there a cost for failure? The success for most Checks is obvious**:** the character accomplishes what they set out to do. But if they fail, what happens? If there is no readily apparent cost for failure, likely because it doesn't truly matter to the story or they could just try again without danger, then it probably doesn't demand a Check.

Is the source of evil menacing them? Whenever a character is asked to make a Check, they might draw an Omen Die, which could cause them harm. If the malevolent entity is in the scene with them, even routine tasks might become dangerous, as the force tries to interfere with their efforts. Note that if the action is itself inherently dangerous, that might call for a Risky Check. If the action carries no possible chance of danger, it might be a Harmless Check. Risky and Harmless Checks are detailed on pages 22–23.

Would a Check make a difference in the story? Finally, and perhaps most crucially, Checks should matter to the outcome of the story. A character searching for chewing gum in their pack might find it easily without a Check, but searching through a cluttered drawer for the key to the basement where a crucial piece of evidence awaits would certainly warrant a Check.

Checks should be common during play but not constant. They should feel like the conclusion to a moment, capping off what one character is trying to accomplish. The Host should avoid calling for multiple Checks to accomplish one task, unless that task is vital to the story's conclusion or central scene. Asking everyone to make the same Check to find an object or avoid a danger is not as momentous as asking one character to face the threat alone. Focusing on how one character deals with a threat or overcomes a

challenge is much better for maintaining the story's momentum and tension, even if that threat is menacing everyone.

Selecting an Aspect

Checks are made using one of the ten Aspects listed on each of the character sheets. Five of these are Core Aspects and are common to every 13 Omens character, while the other five are specific to the story being played. The Host must select the most appropriate Aspect for the task being attempted by the character. A player might offer up suggestions based on their action, but the Host has the final say over what Aspect is being tested.

The Host is free to interpret how each Aspect might apply to an action, and this can change from moment to moment. Breaking open a door is typically a Fight Check, but in the right situation, it might be a Perception Check to spot where the door is cracked.

Setting Difficulty

The character's rating at each Aspect determines the number they need to roll to succeed at the Check, but the Host can set a difficulty that modifies the number needed for success. Checks can be made easier or harder in this way, but the Host should keep in mind that some characters will often succeed at even very hard Checks if they are great at the selected Aspect.

Easy and Very Easy difficulties should be used in situations where even characters with poorly rated Aspects should have a chance to succeed, and those with more skill will almost never fail. Conversely, Hard and Very Hard difficulties should be used in situations where even skilled characters might have a hard time, and those with no experience are almost certain to fail.

Task Difficulty

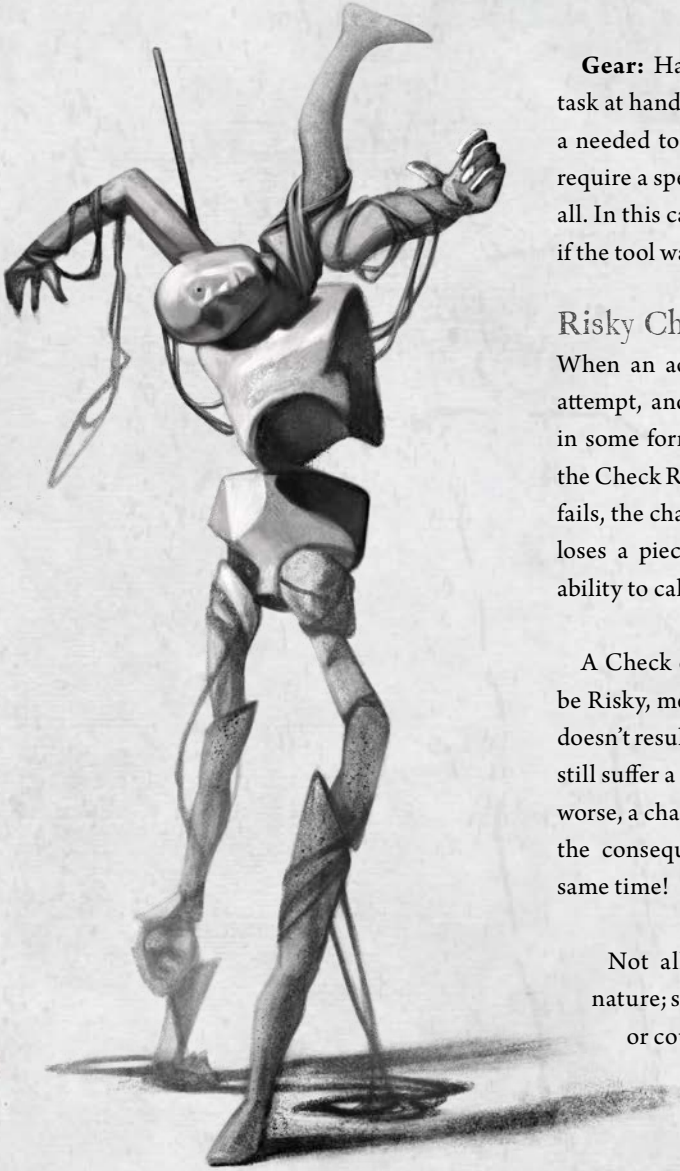
Difficulty	TN modifier
Very Easy	−2
Easy	−1
Average	+0
Hard	+1
Very Hard	+2

Note that difficulty is something inherent to the task, due to its nature or complexity. It is a constant that doesn't change based on circumstance. If an action is being made easier or more difficult due to some form of temporary situation, that calls instead for an Edge or a Flaw to be added to the Check.

Granting Edges and Flaws

Whereas the difficulty of a Check remains unchanged no matter the situation, Edges and Flaws are based entirely on temporary circumstances, useful tools, or outside aid, all of which can change at any time. The Host should grant Edges and Flaws liberally throughout the game, with the understanding that Edges are more common early in the story, while Flaws are more common later. Edges and Flaws come from the following sources, and those from the same source don't stack.

Aid: If another character is meaningfully helping on a task, instead of having both characters roll a Check, the one with the better rating gains an Edge on their Check. Someone actively working against a task counts as a Flaw.



Environment: Sometimes the environment might make a task quite a bit simpler, like trying to hide in a dark room, which grants an Edge. Similarly, the environment might make a task significantly more challenging, like trying to find a missing key in a dark room, granting a Flaw.

Gear: Having an appropriate tool for the task at hand grants an Edge, whereas missing a needed tool is a Flaw. Some actions might require a specific tool to even be attempted at all. In this case, an Edge would be added only if the tool was perfect for the job.

Risky Checks

When an action is inherently dangerous to attempt, and failure almost certainly results in some form of injury, the Host should call the Check Risky. This means that if the Check fails, the character attempting it gets a Strain, loses a piece of Gear, or possibly loses the ability to call upon one of their Perks.

A Check can have both an Omen Die and be Risky, meaning that even if the Omen Die doesn't result in a Wound, the character might still suffer a drawback if the Check fails. Even worse, a character can get a Wound and suffer the consequences of a failed Check at the same time!

Not all Risky Checks are physical in nature; some can test your mental stamina or courage. Trying to read a forbidden tome and understand its blasphemous contents might be a Risky Check.

Harmless Checks

Sometimes an action isn't going to carry a risk of serious harm. The Host can declare such Checks to be Harmless, meaning that if the roll contains an Omen Die, it can't result in a Wound. These are relatively uncommon during the game but should be used whenever a Check is needed to determine the outcome of an action, but it doesn't make sense for the attempt to come with any real danger. Good examples include trying to remember the combination of a safe or noticing a book hidden under a bed. Harmless Checks can sometimes lose that designation later in the story when the stakes are higher and some malevolent force is actively hunting the characters.

Adjudicating Results

After calling for a Check, deciding on the difficulty, and awarding any Edges or Flaws, all that remains is for the player to draw dice from the bag and roll them, comparing the result to their Target Number (see the Aspect Rating Table on page 7). The Host's responsibility is to describe the outcome of the attempt, based on the roll and how close it is to the Target Number. In general, there are three possible outcomes.

Roll is greater than the Target: In this case, the character is successful at accomplishing what they were trying to do. Being successful doesn't guarantee the desired outcome, however. The character might shoot the masked killer countless times, successfully, but that doesn't mean that the killer dies. The most important thing for the Host to remember is that success moves the story forward in a positive way for the players, even if the goal wasn't accomplished. The masked killer might be slowed down, allowing for escape, even if it can't be defeated.

Roll is equal to the Target: When the roll is exactly equal to the target, the character is successful, but just barely. This might not differ much from a normal success, but the best way for the Host to approach this is to describe it as success, but with a small cost or drawback in position, advantage, or time.

Roll is less than the Target: This results in a failure to accomplish the action. If it was a Risky Check, it causes a Strain or the loss of a piece of relevant Gear. Most importantly, failures still move the story forward, even if in a way that is negative for the players. Failures cause additional conflict, lost advantages, or missing knowledge, all of which result in more trouble for the characters in the future.

Omen Dice: If any Omen Dice rolled as part of a Check have a result equal to or less than the current Act, the character receives one Wound, regardless of whether the task is successful. Characters can't get more than one Wound during a single Check, no matter how many Omen Dice are rolled.

Failing Forward

Sometimes a Check can result in failure, but the action is still a success with a significant price, such as the loss of Gear or application of a Strain. The Host can use this to keep the story moving forward, while still making the Checks meaningful.

Acts and Pacing

The body of each 13 Omens story is broken into three Acts, each of which serves a very specific purpose. The Host needs to carefully monitor the progress of the tale and be ready to move between acts when the time is right. Typically, this is done by the Host taking Omen Dice from in front of them and adding the Omen Dice either to the bag or directly to a roll about to be made by one of the players.

Omen Dice Pacing

At the start of each session, the Host should lay out the Omen Dice in front of them, with none of them being in the bag or in front of any other players. The addition of Omen Dice to the bag or to players' Checks controls the pace of the story in 13 Omens, with more dice in play being in direct relation to the danger faced by the characters. Whenever an Omen Die is added by the Host to the game, it can be added directly to the bag, typically in response to some turn in the story or menacing change in the environment, or it can be added to a Check that is about to be made as a Flaw. This latter option is great for adding tension to the moment and should be used when a character is interacting directly with the evil force that is at the heart of the story.

The Host always adds an Omen Die to the bag at the conclusion of the Prologue. They then add the rest of the Omen Dice at their discretion, but as they are added, the nature of the story changes. Eventually, the next Act begins, according to the following general guidelines.

Act One

This Act serves as a time to ground the story and allow the characters to get to know one another. The evil that eventually comes to dominate the story is dormant, waiting, building in strength. It's nature is not yet obvious to the characters, but the signs are there, if only the characters are clever enough to see them. During this Act, three Omen Dice are added to play (bringing the total up to four).

Act Two

The fifth Omen Die is added at the very start of Act Two. During this Act, the evil manifests, usually by taking some direct action against the characters. From this point onward, the pace of the story and the level of tension constantly build. What was once a subtle malice is now overt. The characters realize the danger they are in and should start desperately seeking to escape or overcome the evil. During this Act, a total of four Omen Dice are added to play (bringing the total up to eight).

Act Three

Act Three begins when the ninth Omen Die is added to play. The final Act of the story features a showdown with the malevolence that has hunted the characters throughout the story. If they are fortunate, throughout the first two Acts, the characters have discovered some way to escape or vanquish the evil. In this Act, they desperately work together to accomplish their goal or die in the attempt. The thirteenth Omen Die should be added to the final scene of the story. Due to the high risk of Wounds, many characters may perish during this Act.



Speeding up the Game

It is very important in the first Act to keep the story moving toward the danger. In this part of the tale, it's easy for the players to get comfortable, exploring their personalities and the environment that they find themselves in. Allowing some open roleplay is critical in giving the players time to form a bond with their character and those of the other players, which adds stakes to the danger they face later, but allowing it to linger for too long can drain any tension the Host is trying to build. In most games, the first Act should be no more than about one hour in length at the table.

If the characters are slow to leave a scene, the Host can usually encourage action through the use of nonplayer characters, ominous environmental changes, and direct calls for action. Throughout this, the addition of Omen Dice to the bag serves to remind the players that the evil around them is growing in strength.

Borrowed Time (optional)

Due to poor luck or bad circumstances, a character might perish very early in the story or at a moment where it just doesn't make sense for them to die, leading to a serious problem with the pace of the tale. In this case, the Host can declare that they're living on borrowed time. At any point later in the story, the Host can decide that the character dies, preferably in a moment that is more appropriate to the narrative.

Adapting the Tale

Every 13 Omens story is arranged in scenes, discrete moments in the tale where something important happens to further the narrative. Depending on the story, scenes can happen sequentially, based on some element of timing, or they might be organized spatially and resolved in the order in which they are explored. Player choices in guiding their characters can directly influence the organization of scenes, sometimes in ways that the story did not predict. That is where the Host steps in to keep the story moving toward its terrifying conclusion.



Using existing scenes to bridge any gaps in the story is often the easiest way to keep things moving. If, for example, there was a scene set in a moonlit clearing that is pivotal to the plot, but the characters instead went to the lake, where nothing happens, it might be easiest to just move this critical scene so that it occurs at the lake instead. This is why the Host should have a good understanding of the overall plot and its scenes before play begins. Knowing the rough shape of the tale makes it much easier to improvise and adjust components so that it fits the pace of play.

This is not to imply that every choice made by the players should lead to exactly where they need to go, but if they seem stumped or have lost the trail of the plot, this method is a relatively unobtrusive way to bring the story back to them. Most of the time, they will never even notice that the change took place.

Shifting Plot

Sometimes, moving a scene is not enough to get a story back on track. This most likely occurs when the characters advance farther into the plot than they are meant to based on the number of Omen Dice in play, such as when they stumble into a scene that is not meant to happen until a later Act. The Host

has a variety of ways to keep things moving by shifting around some elements of the plot to work with the choices made by the characters.

The simplest is just to delay the primary events of the scene until the timing is right, but this works best if the characters are likely to find themselves in the right situation for that scene again. Alternatively, the central elements of the scene can get moved to another scene or held in reserve until the moment is right. This works best in stories where the scenes are fluid, based more on events and time than location.

Finally, the Host can simply map elements from an earlier scene that they skipped into the scene they are now dealing with, adapting the details as needed to keep the story moving as intended. All of these require some amount of quick improvisation from the Host, who should feel free to take a moment to think it through to find a good way to continue the story.

Inventing Moments

As a last resort, if a Host is facing a story that has gotten entirely off course, they might want to invent an entirely new scene to bridge elements of the story together. If the characters get lost in a mine while investigating a murder, for example, the Host might invent a scene where they uncover a new dead body and a trail of blood, which leads to a long-forgotten air shaft that leads them back to where the other scenes are set to take place. Remember that unrevealed scenes can easily be adapted to help bridge parts of the story that have become disconnected and that the structure presented in each can usually be rearranged without the players knowing the difference.

Different Group Sizes

13 Omens is designed to run with five players, with one serving as Host while the other four are characters, but it can accommodate smaller and larger groups. For groups with only three characters, run the game as normal, but each character can remove one Strain at any one point during the game, explaining it away in a way that fits the story. For groups with only two characters, each can take one additional Wound before succumbing to the darkness. For a story with only one character, increase this to two additional Wounds.

It is not advisable to run 13 Omens with too large a group, as a good horror tale requires time for each character to grow and face the darkness. For a group with five characters, each takes one fewer Wound before they perish. For a group with six characters, each takes two fewer Wounds before they die, but once two have perished, this number changes to one fewer wound (in effect, the first two characters die easier than the last four). It is not recommended to run the game with more than six players and one Host. Note that most 13 Omens stories include only five Archetypes, but in a group with six characters, there can be two characters based off the same Archetype, though their players should work together to ensure their characters are sufficiently distinct.

Lingering Spirits (optional)

Characters might linger on after death, hoping to aid those that they once called friends. The Host can, at their discretion, inform a player whose character has just died that they can linger on as a helpful spirit. At any one time, later in the story, that player can interrupt a scene with a brief flashback to when their character was still alive. During this flashback, they are allowed to describe a way in which they did something that might help the current situation. For example, the spirit player might declare that earlier that day, they dropped some extra batteries into the backpack of another player, or they might declare that they accidentally spilled a glass of water, creating a hazard for the killer as it stalks the other characters. In any case, this flashback can grant one minor benefit to the living characters, such as a simple piece of gear or an Edge on any one Check. Each spirit can use this flashback power only once during the remainder of the story.

Losing Characters

Death and despair are a very real possibility for characters in 13 Omens. The Omen Dice can cause Wounds very easily in the third Act, and even cautious players might take their last wound and fall. The Host serves a vital role in these final moments, narrating the character's last breath, as evil closes in around them. Every death or moment of despair in this game should be a memorable part of the story, and the Host should look for ways to work with the player to make it count, be it with one final quip or some small act of defiance. As a reminder, losing a character in 13 Omens is not a failure if the story you all told together was engaging and memorable.

Concluding the Story

Each story of 13 Omens concludes with the characters either escaping their desperate situation, defeating some evil force, or just living to fight another day. Sometimes a group might entirely succumb to darkness, being swallowed whole and never heard from again. All these situations can still provide a satisfying ending to the story, depending entirely upon how it is handled and the ways in which the Host draws things to a close.

Each story includes two possible endings, one of which is adapted by the Host to fit the circumstances of their game. The first of these should be used if the group succeeds in their goal or simply survives the nightmares they just faced. This ending is uplifting, a moment of relief from the terrors they fought against. It is unlikely that everyone lived to see this ending, but all the players can take some measure of ownership in this success. The other ending is to be used if everyone falls into death or despair. This ending may be grim, but the story was about their perseverance to the very end and how they might give the next doomed souls a better chance of success.

Of course, the outcome of a story is unlikely to perfectly match either ending presented in the conclusion, and the Host should be prepared to adjust the narrative as needed to fit the events of their tale.

Evil Never Dies

No matter how the story wraps up, there is one last note for the Host to keep in mind with their final narration. Evil never truly dies. Even if the monster was killed, the demon sent back to hell, or the haunted house burned to the ground, there is always some spark of evil that remains. The world is full of such faint malignancies, waiting to grow and terrorize the living once again. Perhaps the monster had offspring, the demon was just one of many, or the haunted house is replaced with a shopping mall, one with a dark secret.

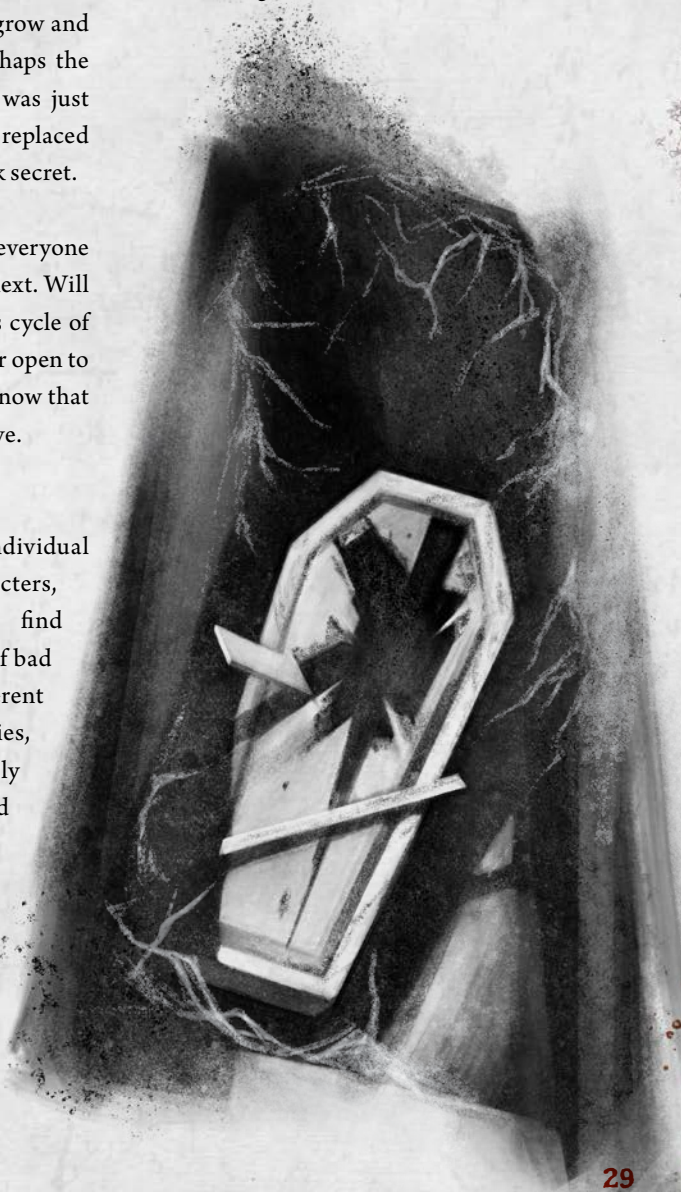
The end of the story should leave everyone at the table wondering what comes next. Will they ever truly manage to bring this cycle of horror to a close? This leaves the door open to a sequel, but it also lets the players know that "winning" was never the real objective.

The Next Story

13 Omens is designed to tell individual stories with unique groups of characters, but those who survive might find themselves in a sequel or, in a run of bad luck, drawn into an entirely different tale of terror and woe. In many stories, other Archetypes, or even other fully made characters, can be inserted with only minimal work by the Host to invent a reason as to why this might make sense. Perhaps the lone survivor of a camp massacre can become the central figure in a legacy of nightmares, or perhaps their ultimate fate is waiting for them at the end of the next story!

Telling Your Own Story

Countless tales of terror are waiting to be told in the world of 13 Omens. You could use the archetypes presented in "The Haunting of Hollybrook" to tell dozens of tales exploring the misadventures of the *Ghost Stormers* crew. Look for complete story creation guidelines in the full release of this game in 2027.





The Haunting of Hollybrook

The venerable mansion known as Hollybrook has been an institution on the Oregon coast for over 100 years, first as the summer retreat for a wealthy lumber family, then as a bed and breakfast. The place was inherited by Emily Pettywood in 1975 from a distant relative, and she spent several years and most of her savings transforming it into a comfortable and stylish inn overlooking the Pacific Ocean.

For over a decade she saw some success, but as the years progressed, the inn started to show its age. Soon the year-round business became mostly seasonal. Emily, who by this time was known to the guests as "Granny," became depressed at the collapse of her dream and began to obsess over every bad review and criticism left in her guidebook. The bitterness consumed her.

In the late 90s, the advent of online reviews only caused the slow decline of her business to speed up into a complete collapse. By 2004, the end was in sight and bankruptcy loomed. Granny, now in her 60s, twisted by her rage at these so-called reviewers, hatched a vile plan.

She invited all her worst critics to a grand reopening, promising them a free weekend and a wonderful time. One by one, they arrived, each taken to a clean, well-appointed room. That evening, Granny invited them to a very special dinner to celebrate their visit. But it was all a ruse. Granny poisoned most of the guests and spent the rest of the evening hunting down and murdering the rest with her heavy, wooden rolling pin. At the end of the night, after all the guests were dead, Granny went to the attic and took her own life.

But that was not the end of her story.

The Hollybrook Inn has been empty for 20 years. On this evening, a documentary crew called the *Ghost Stormers* is set to arrive at the inn, hoping to film the ghost that supposedly haunts this place. Shortly after arriving, the crew confirms that the ghost of Granny is in fact quite real. Locked inside with no way to escape, the *Ghost Stormers* will have to evade Granny's attacks and her numerous ghostly traps, discover the place where she died, and learn that her vengeful spirit is tied to the Hollybrook guest book, which is buried in the basement. With a bit of luck, they might just dig up the guest book and destroy it, potentially freeing Granny from her endless murderous rampage and saving themselves at the same time.

Content Consideration

The Haunting of Hollybrook is a ghost story featuring the site of a mass murder, poisoning, suicide, implied cannibalism, and violent, bloody, supernatural terror. In addition to this, some of the Archetypes include mentions of alcohol and drug use. Before starting this story with your group, make sure to discuss this content to make sure everyone is okay with having these themes be a part of the story.

Introduction

At the start of the session, read the following introduction to the players to give them a sense of the story they're about to experience.

"A terrifying tempest of tormented souls has settled on our world, and within it the dead don't rest easy! Welcome to Ghost Stormers, the only show that dares to show you real haunts and horrifying spirits!"

You've probably heard the opening of your show a thousand times by now, and to be honest, it gets a bit tiresome. The five of you are in the Ghost Stormer van, driving along the Pacific coast in Oregon, looking for the site of your next episode. It's another run-down, abandoned dump that will, at the very least, make for great visuals. Supposedly the place closed over 20 years ago after what the local papers called "a grisly scene of murder and mayhem," but for your group, that is just about the norm. Every week is some new "haunted" place that is usually no more than a dilapidated wreck that you and the crew spice up with simple practical effects. But it draws in the viewers, and that's all that matters.

Maybe this time will be different.

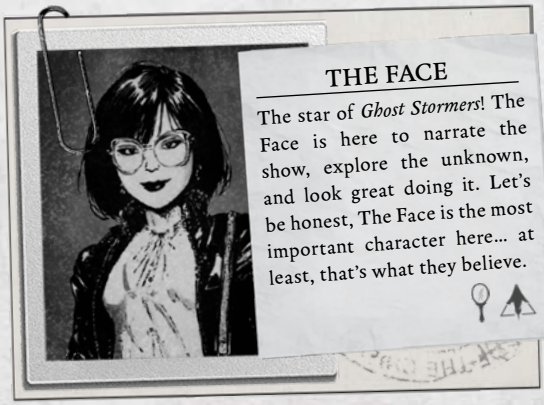
The owner of the inn supposedly invited all their critics here for a grand reopening and slaughtered them all in one horrifying evening. Sounds perfect for your show, even if you will probably have to add all the "real" ghosts yourselves.

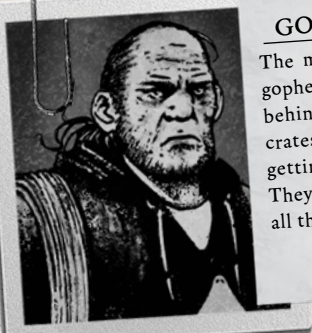
Archetype Summary

The Ghost Stormers crew consists of three regular members, including the Face, the presenter of the show, the Tech Specialist, who operates the camera and sound gear, and the Gopher Supreme, who gets everything moved in, set up, and ready to go. In addition, there are two others traveling along to the abandoned Hollybrook Inn. The Local Fan is the caretaker of the property, and a big fan of the show. Finally, the True Believer is this week's guest performer, here to tell the Face all about the paranormal and the ghosts that inhabit this location.

Read or paraphrase the above synopsis for the players so that they can make informed decisions about which Archetype they would like to play for this story. Any archetypes not chosen can be played by the Host as background characters. If the group needs six characters, consider doubling up on either the Tech Specialist (with one focused on sound and one on video) or the Face (giving the show a "co-host").

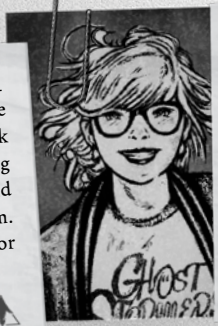
After the players have selected their Archetypes and created their characters, proceed to Act One.





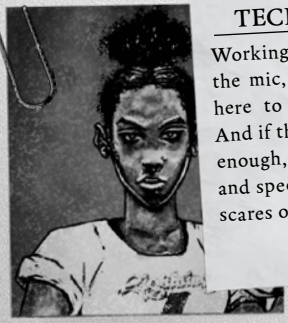
GOPHER SUPREME

The muscle of the crew. The gopher does most of the work behind the scenes, moving crates, setting up lights, and getting things ready to film. They are rarely appreciated for all the effort.



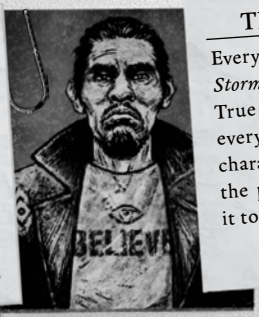
LOCAL FAN

Living on the coast, this character called in the *Ghost Stormers* to come take a look at a haunted property that they manage. They also happen to be the biggest *Ghost Stormers* fan in the world!



TECH SPECIALIST

Working both the camera and the mic, the Tech Specialist is here to get the perfect shot. And if the location isn't spooky enough, they have a kit of tricks and special effects to add some scares of their own.



TRUE BELIEVER

Every episode of *Ghost Stormers* has a guest, and the True Believer is here to show everyone the truth! This character wants to experience the paranormal and showcase it to the entire world!



THE FACE

You are the star, the voice, and the narrator of Ghost Stormers, an online reality show that visits creepy, old, abandoned places in search of paranormal encounters. In truth, you've never seen anything to convince you that any of it is real, but with a few cheap tricks like out of focus lenses, hidden smoke machines, and a lot of overacting, your show sure does rake in the viewership numbers. And that's the only thing that matters. Before this show was a hit, you were stuck in a series of dead-end jobs, with entirely too much debt. This show is everything for you, and you will do anything to make sure it succeeds.



GOAL: You will stop at nothing, including endangering yourself and the rest of the crew, to ensure this show is a success, especially if it means you can beat out the "Ghost Bros" (a rival show).

Possible Personality Traits: Choose from among the traits on this list or add your own**:** *Arrogant, Cynical, Demanding, Demeaning, Driven, Grandstanding, Greedy, Melodramatic, Oblivious, Overreacting, Self-Centered, Selfish, Snarky.*

Relations to Other Characters: The following suggestions cover how you might feel about the other characters.

Gopher Supreme: They do all the grunt work so you can earn everyone's paycheck. Often a distraction, they could work a little harder, a little faster, and a lot quieter.

Local Fan: The fan is entirely too excited about the show, but keeping them happy is part of the job. It's irksome that they seem to want to pay attention to the crew.

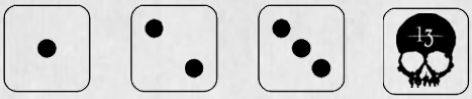
Tech Specialist: Your partner in making the show "work." An expert at cameras, sound, and lighting, their real specialty is making everything look extra scary, even if that means inventing a ghost or faking a haunting.

True Believer: Each episode features a guest to be the "ignorant" one so that you can explain the paranormal to them. The only problem here is that they seem to believe this paranormal crap...

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NAME: _____

TRAITS: _____



CORE ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Courage			☐
Evade			☐
Fight			☐
Luck			☐
Perception			☐

STORY ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Charm	*Great*	4	☐
Ghost Stormers Lore			☐
Mechanics			☐
Occultism			☐
Technology			☐

PERKS

Choose any two of the following Perks.

☐ **Bossy:** Once per Act, you can demand that another character in the scene with you aid you on your Check, granting you an Edge. But instead of taking the two highest die results, you take the highest and the lowest die result.

☐ **Demand Focus:** Whenever you attempt a Charm Check to draw attention to yourself, you add an Edge to the roll.

☐ **Face Danger:** You are brave on camera. Once per scene, if you are being recorded, you can cancel up to one Flaw on any Check caused by a supernatural or dangerous event.

☐ **Nonbeliever:** You don't believe any of this stuff is real. When confronting something supernatural, you can ignore up to one Flaw on the Check if you refuse to acknowledge the reality of the situation. If that supernatural thing becomes undeniably real, you lose the use of this Perk for the rest of the story.

☐ **Self-Confident:** You are quite assured of yourself. Once per Act, you can spend one minute giving yourself a pep talk to add an Edge to one Check you attempt in the next minute.

☐ **Wealthy:** You start the story with up to eight items from the list of possible gear, instead of four. You also have $500 in cash.

GEAR

Your character starts with a Mic and up to four selections from the following list: *Branded T-Shirt, Cell Phone, Flashlight, Flashy Jewelry, Flask, Ghost Detector, History Book, Infrared Camera, Laptop, Makeup Kit, Map of the Hollybrook Inn, Six Copies of Your Self-Published Memoir*

GOPHER SUPREME

Listen, somebody has to carry all the gear, get the scenes set up, and fetch whatever folks need to make sure a shoot goes quickly and smoothly. That's you, and you take pride in your work. You joined Ghost Stormers in hopes that it might lead to bigger, better things, but so far, the only thing it has led to is more work and very little pay. Honestly, you're kinda fed up with it all. You can get anything they need, but they don't seem to appreciate you at all.



GOAL: You hate this crappy job and its obnoxious host, but you need it to pay the bills. All you really want to do is sneak away to work on your screenplay (your ticket out of this lousy situation).

Possible Personality Traits: Choose from among the traits on this list or add your own**:** *Burnt Out, Distracted, Fed Up, Frustrated, Grumbly, Helpful, Overprepared, Passive Aggressive, Practical Joker, Sarcastic, Snarky, Tired.*

Relations to Other Characters: The following suggestions cover how you might feel about the other characters.

The Face: Total ass. Full of themself and unwilling to give anybody else even an ounce of credit for the show's success. Doesn't care about your problems, your bills, or your future.

Local Fan: Fans of the show rarely even know that you exist, and most try to just use you to get to the Face. This fan knows your name, and it kinda creeps you out. Way too eager.

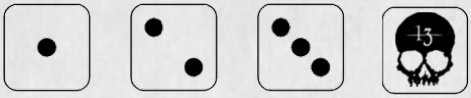
Tech Specialist: Probably your only actual friend on the crew. You two make everything happen behind the scenes, from blocking and loading in gear to setting up the ghosts and other paranormal tricks. You often play pranks on them.

True Believer: There is always a new guest each week, and this one is a weirdo. They actually seem to believe all this paranormal stuff. You are sure that after just one episode, they'll change their mind.

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NAME: _____

TRAITS: _____



CORE ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Courage			☐
Evade			☐
Fight			☐
Luck			☐
Perception			☐

STORY ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Charm			☐
Ghost Stormers Lore			☐
Mechanics	*Great*	4	☐
Occultism			☐
Technology			☐

PERKS

Choose any two of the following Perks.

☐ **Carry On: You never take a Flaw on any Check when you have three Omen Dice in front of you.**

☐ **Five Minute Break:** Once per story, you can take a 5-minute break to relax and unwind. If you are not interrupted or disturbed during this time, you can remove a Strain.

☐ **Gripe and Complain:** Once per Act, you can complain about your situation when you make a roll with a Flaw. Instead of taking the two lowest dice, you take the highest and the lowest dice.

☐ **Pack Mule:** You start play with six items from the list of suggested items, instead of four. In addition, at one point during the story, you can select one additional item from the list that you "forgot" you had on you.

☐ **Perfect Tool:** Once per story, you can find the "perfect" tool for any one roll that could benefit from a tool (like a hammer, a screwdriver, or a jeweler's saw). You gain an Edge on that roll and can keep the item.

☐ **Quick Search:** You can search an area twice as fast as others or cover an area twice as large, without taking a Flaw to the roll.

GEAR

Your character starts with an Unfinished Screenplay, a Weight Belt, and up to four from the following: *Cell Phone, Cigarettes and Lighter, Cleanup Kit, Power Cables, First Aid Kit, Flask, Hammer, Helmet with Light, Leather Jacket, Lighting Rig, Pocket Handgun with 6 shots, Screwdriver Set, Smoke Machine, Sound System, Sweatbands, Work Glove*

THE FAN

You are a local, paid by a real-estate broker to look after several properties out along the coast. It doesn't pay much, but it gives you plenty of time for your hobbies, like watching and participating in the Ghost Stormers fan community. No one is as big of a fan of Ghost Stormers as you are. Of course, you know the Face of the show, everybody does, but you pay special attention to all the guests and the folks behind the camera. For the past few years, you have been submitting some of the local haunted places out on the coast, knowing that this could be your big chance to meet the team.



GOAL: You really want to get every member of the Ghost Stormers to sign your fan notebook with some sort of message. You also want to nab any souvenirs you can find from their gear.

Possible Personality Traits: Choose from among the traits on this list or add your own**:** *Defensive, Eager, Excitable, Friendly, Irritating, Knowledgeable, Overfamiliar, Particular, Passionate, Protective, Talkative*

Relations to Other Characters: The following suggestions cover how you might feel about the other characters.

The Face: Absolutely the best in the business at tracking down ghosts and turning any random haunting into a thrilling adventure. You are awestruck by their presence and just want them to notice you.

Gopher Supreme: You know this character by name, and you are very proud of that fact. Most viewers don't know the folks behind the camera at all! Maybe you can make friends.

Tech Specialist: A true maestro at capturing all the magic that is the *Ghost Stormers* show. You have even tracked down some of their solo work and a film they made back in school! You've got so many technical questions.

True Believer: This week's guest and ghost expert. You don't know too much about them… yet. Maybe they're as big a fan of the show as you are? Surely you can bond with them about your love of *Ghost Stormers*!

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NAME: _____

TRAITS: _____

CORE ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Courage			☐
Evade			☐
Fight			☐
Luck			☐
Perception			☐

STORY ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Charm			☐
Ghost Stormers Lore	*Great*	4	☐
Mechanics			☐
Occultism			☐
Technology			☐

PERKS

Choose any two of the following Perks.

☐ **Eager to Help:** Once per Act, when you give aid to a character, you also cancel out up to one additional Flaw on that roll.

☐ **Encyclopedic Memory:** Once per Act, you can add an Edge to any Ghost Stormers Lore Check you attempt.

☐ **Got to Impress:** When you are around the *Ghost Stormers*, you have a boost of confidence. Once per Act, if you are being observed by two or more members of the team, you can add one Edge to any Check you attempt.

☐ **In Episode 17...:** You remember everything about the show, including where useful gear might be hiding. Once per Act, give another character any one small handheld piece of Gear by reminding them where they put it in a previous episode.

☐ **Local Edge:** You've been in this house before and know your way around. Once per Act, you can cancel out a Flaw on one Evade or Perception Check.

☐ **Lucky:** Once per game, you can use your Luck in place of any other Aspect when called upon to make a Check.

GEAR

Your character starts with a Fan Notebook, Hollybrook Keyring, and Ghost Stormers DVD, and up to four selections from the following list: *Anxiety Medication, Cell Phone, Disposable Camera, Ghost "Meter," Ghost Stormers Brand Flashlight Prototype, Gopher's Favorite Candy Bar, Host's Headshot, Local Guidebook, Pocket Knife, Tech's Brand of Headphones.*

TECH SPECIALIST

Recording quality, lighting considerations, room noise, battery life, storage space—you have too much to keep track of to get bogged down in all the petty drama of the other folks on the show. For you, this gig is just another chance to refine your craft. It has allowed you to learn how to create practical effects in the field, whipping up ghosts, foggy images, and spooky sounds. Who knows, maybe this show will eventually lead to better work, but your art comes first.



GOAL: You've been working on a demo reel that you hope to send to a Hollywood studio, so you are constantly on the lookout for evocative scenes.

Possible Personality Traits: Choose from among the traits on this list or add your own**:** *Chill, Dedicated, Drama Averse, Focused, Giving, Humble, Kind, Professional, Quiet Humor, Supportive, Understated*

Relations to Other Characters: The following suggestions cover how you might feel about the other characters.

The Face: Filming them day after day has become dull, but the new locations and added effects keep things interesting. They genuinely appreciate your skill, and you're eager to work with them to make the show great.

Gopher Supreme: Great person to have around. They help you get things set up and hang out with you between takes. You let them play pranks on you, even though you almost always see them coming.

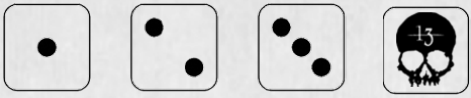
Local Fan: Fans rarely pay you much attention, except for the occasional film enthusiast. This one seems to actually treat you like a big part of the show, which is refreshing, even if they are a bit *much*.

True Believer: The guest of the week is rarely easy to work with. They stare at the wrong thing, talk too quietly, and they ruin shots constantly. This weirdo is unlikely to be any different.

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NAME: _____

TRAITS: _____



CORE ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Courage			☐
Evade			☐
Fight			☐
Luck			☐
Perception			☐

STORY ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Charm			☐
Ghost Stormers Lore			☐
Mechanics			☐
Occultism			☐
Technology	*Great*	4	☐

PERKS

Choose any two of the following Perks.

☐ **Chill Out:** You ignore the first Flaw on any Courage Check that you attempt. You lose this Perk if Courage is Strained.

☐ **Close Up:** You get an Edge on any Perception Check made while filming or when reviewing footage.

☐ **Junk Bag:** You start the story with up to six pieces of gear instead of four. In addition, at any one point during the story, you can select one additional item from the list that you "forgot" you had on you.

☐ **Shot Focused:** While filming, you get an Edge on any check you are forced to make in response to something that you see through your lens.

☐ **Tech Pro:** Once per Act, you can add an Edge to any Technology Check.

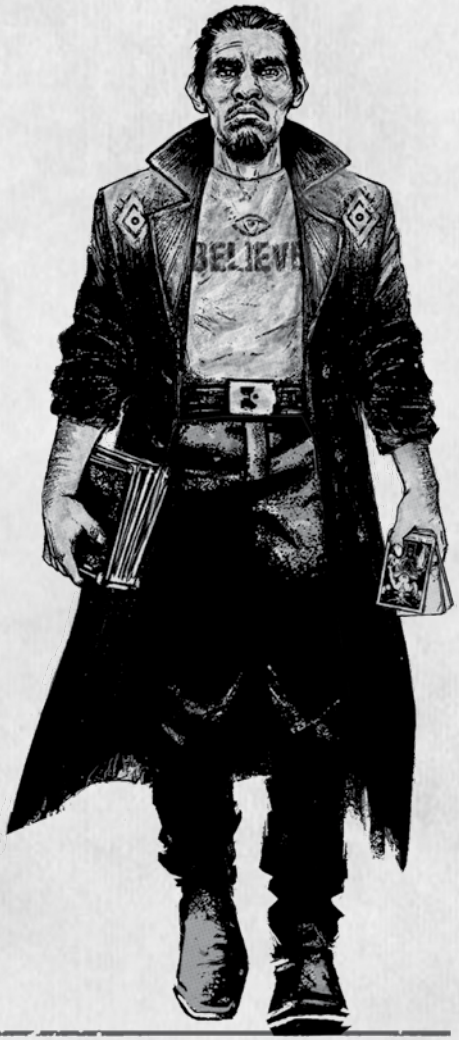
☐ **Tinkerer:** You can attempt a Technology Check to try to get a piece of gear to perform in a way it was not designed to perform, like setting up a recording device to act like an alarm or using a smoke machine as a trap. The difficulty of the task and how long it remains functional are up to the Host.

GEAR

Your character starts with a Camera, Sound Gear, and Light Rig, and up to four selections from the following list**:** *Backup Battery, Boom Mic, Cassette Recorder, Cell Phone, Fog Machine, Ghost Rig, Joints and a Lighter, Light Gel Kit, Palm-Sized Backup Camera, Pocket Knife, Scary Prop Box, Small Pyrotechnics Kit, Tablet Computer, Tub of Grease, Wiring Kit*

TRUE BELIEVER

Finally, this is your chance to prove to the world that all is not as it seems, that strange forces work in the shadows for unknown and nefarious purposes, that the dead do not rest easy, and that you are certainly, for sure, the only person who knows the whole truth. Ghost Stormers might be a scam, but tonight you are going to show them and their audience something real. As a guest of the show, you are going to speak to the ghosts that haunt this place and get them to reveal themselves to the world.



GOAL: You will do anything to expose "The Truth" to the world, hopefully by getting this crew to film something supernatural on camera, even if you must draw out the forces yourself.

Possible Personality Traits: Choose from among the traits on this list or add your own**:** *Arrogant, Awkward, Convinced, Gullible, Mysterious, Nerdy, Oblivious, Obsessed, Passionate, Shy, Zealous*

Relations to Other Characters: The following suggestions cover how you might feel about the other characters.

The Face: The only one on this crew that might just believe you, but they seem more concerned about getting the right shots and looking good. Still, you think they're certainly ready to hear "The Truth." They might even know some things that you don't!

Gopher Supreme: They haul stuff around, you think. You should tell them about "The Truth," but as they're uninitiated, you should be sure to go easy on them.

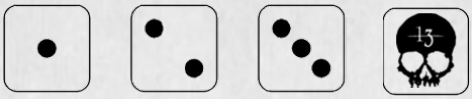
Local Fan: Just another fan of the paranormal who would be shocked to learn "The Truth." You doubt this one is ready, especially since they are more interested in impressing the cast than experiencing the paranormal.

Tech Specialist: Films and records everything. Getting them to record and broadcast "The Truth" will be vital. You need them as an ally.

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NAME: _____

TRAITS: _____



CORE ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Courage			☐
Evade			☐
Fight			☐
Luck			☐
Perception			☐

STORY ASPECTS	RATING	TN	STRAIN
Charm			☐
Ghost Stormers Lore			☐
Mechanics			☐
Occultism	Great	4	☐
Technology			☐

PERKS

Choose any two of the following Perks.

☐ **Awkward Pause:** Once per story, you can reroll any one Check you just made using the same dice, taking the better result.

☐ **Believer:** You believe all this is real. When confronting something supernatural, you can ignore one Flaw on the roll if you believe that the phenomenon is real. If that supernatural thing is proved undeniably fake, you lose the use of this Perk for the rest of the story.

☐ **Insight into the Occult:** You get an Edge when making a Check to try to understand any supernatural event or magical effect.

☐ **Invisible:** It's like you aren't even there. Once per Act, you can force a different character in the scene to make a Check that is being asked of you.

☐ **Strange Ritual:** Once per Act, you can perform a ritual to give another character an Edge on any one Check they attempt in the next minute.

☐ **The Truth:** You know "The Truth." You place an Omen Die in front of you only if it rolls a 1, regardless of the Act, but you die or succumb to death or despair if you ever have two Omen Dice in front of you instead of four, and you can never Cheat Death.

GEAR

Your character starts with a Book About Spirits, a Copy of your Manifesto, and up to four selections from the following list: *Assortment of Crystals, Bag of Powdered Silver, Believer T-Shirt, Box of Coyote Crunch Snack Mix, Cell Phone, Flashlight, Medication, Package of Incense, Polyhedral Dice, Spirit Board, RPG Rulebook, Spirit Guidebook, Tarot Deck*



Prologue

A lone figure hikes along the side of the road, his thumb raised for any car that happens to pass by. But none of them stop, and a storm rolls in just as the sun begins to set. Driving rain and howling wind make the trek along the lonely stretch of Pacific Highway a miserable one. The man soon begins to wonder if he will be able to find any sort of shelter for the night.

Up ahead, in a flash of lightning, he spies a dark shape, looming up at the edge of the cliff that leads down to the beach and the roar of the Pacific. It's an old, abandoned manor house. Although there are no lights on, spending the night inside has got to be better than staying out here. He slips through the rusty chain-link fence that surrounds the place and makes his way up to the front door. It opens with a loud creak.

Venturing inside, he stumbles through a darkened foyer before entering a ruined great hall. Rotting wood boards cover the broken glass windows, doing little to stop the wind from swirling piles of debris around the room. In the corner of his eye, he spots a fireplace and quickly rushes over to it. In his haste, he fails to hear the gentle footsteps coming from somewhere up above.

Using debris for kindling, the traveler digs through his pack for his lighter. With shaky hands, he strikes the flint, getting only the palest flame that has trouble igniting the fuel. The first curls of smoke dim the faint illumination, hiding the chalk outlines upon the dirty floor. The traveler also fails to notice the dark crimson stains that dot the room. He is so consumed with getting the fire started that he doesn't see the dark shape rising behind him. It's a squat, broad form, wrapped in some sort of filthy cloak or shawl. As the fire finally flickers to life, the traveler's face looks relieved, oblivious to the danger behind him. The shape raises up an arm to strike. As it steps forward, the floorboards creak.

The traveler turns, his expression of elation turning to fear.

The blow lands with a sickening crack of bone, and the man slumps to the floor.

After reading this prologue, place all eight Safe Dice into the bag along with one Omen Die. Proceed to Act One.

Act One

The story begins with the *Ghost Stormers* van having just pulled up to the Hollybrook Inn. Dark and foreboding clouds loom overhead, forcing the crew to get their gear unpacked quickly before the rain starts pouring down. Once inside, they find the inn in terrible shape and begin to set up to film their show. The most likely place to start is the great hall, which is still covered in police tape from where all the bodies were found 20 years ago. But just as they are about to begin, the dead body of a hitchhiker (from the prologue) suspended from the ceiling falls on them from above.

Further exploration of the inn reveals only more disturbing signs. The kitchen seems to still be in use, with an ominous pie in the oven and a rusty cleaver embedded in the kitchen table. The study has large a display of taxidermy birds that watch the characters as they investigate, and the rooms upstairs clearly show signs of struggle and murder. Throughout this, small supernatural events start to occur, as the ghost of Granny stirs, angry at the presence of the *Ghost Stormers*.

It's likely the Host will add three Omen Dice to the bag before the characters can explore every scene in this Act, leaving the other scenes for the players to experience during Act Two. Act One comes to a close just as the ghost of Granny decides to make itself known.

Structure

Act One starts with the Arrival scene, but the other scenes are location based, happening when the characters explore a specific part of the inn. Of particular interest are the great hall, the kitchen, the library, and the bedrooms upstairs. Also note that during this first Act, a terrible storm rolls into the area after about 30 minutes into the story (measure in real time).

Arrival

The *Ghost Stormers* crew spent most of the afternoon on the road from Portland to arrive at the Hollybrook Inn, situated on the central Oregon coast. The crumbling edifice, once a quaint manor house turned into a fancy bed & breakfast, was abandoned after the events of 2004. This scene begins with the van parked just outside the dilapidated ruin.

In this scene, the characters can investigate the area around the inn and find a way inside. They can also learn about the history of this place and the grim murders that happened here over 20 years ago. The sun begins to set once the *Ghost Stormers* arrive, dipping below dark, gathering stormclouds.

Examining the Building: The inn itself is an old two-story structure with an attic and a basement, likely built in the late 1890s, although it was clearly maintained until about 20 years ago. Sun-bleached boards cover the mansion's broken windows, missing shingles give the slumped roof the appearance of a nasty rash, and much of the paint long ago peeled from its rotten siding. In short, the place is a ruin, likely filled with rot, filth, and vermin.

Search the Grounds: A cursory search of the area doesn't reveal much. Decades have passed since the last time anyone maintained the grounds, which are now entirely overrun with weeds and a massive blackberry bush. The inn sits on a crumbling cliff face that might one day give way, causing the entire building to slide down into the crashing ocean over 100 feet below. There appears to be only one way to get inside the inn, through the boarded up front door.

History of the Inn: An Occultism Check reveals that this place was the site of a gruesome series of murders back in 2004. According to the local papers, the owner of the inn, Granny Pettywood, invited all her critics and reviewers to the inn for a grand reopening. Throughout the weekend, she poisoned many of them and murdered several more with a variety of kitchen tools. All told, 17 people were killed. Granny Pettywood took her own life as the police arrived.

Opening the Door: The front door is unlocked but boarded over. A Fight Check can pry off the boards, while a Hard Perception Check points to a discarded hammer sitting behind a nearby flower pot, allowing the boards to be easily removed.

The Foyer: Sheets of cobwebs billow in the breeze inside the front door of the dusty foyer. It's clear that the door hasn't always been closed, judging by the amount of leaves and the piles of debris found here. A podium stands near the door. A Perception Check reveals that the inn's guest book is missing.

Unloading the Van: It starts to rain shortly after the crew arrives, and they must work fast to unload the van. One character must attempt an Evade Check to go fast or a Fight Check to make fewer trips. Failing this Check means that the gear is still loaded inside, but the character is soaked and takes a Flaw on all Checks until they can dry off.

Storm Intensifies

After about 30 minutes of real time (at least 5 minutes after concluding the Arrival scene), the storm outside intensifies. A tremendous boom thunders overhead, and the rain outside begins to pour down in sheets. **After describing the sudden onslaught, add one Omen Die directly to the bag.**

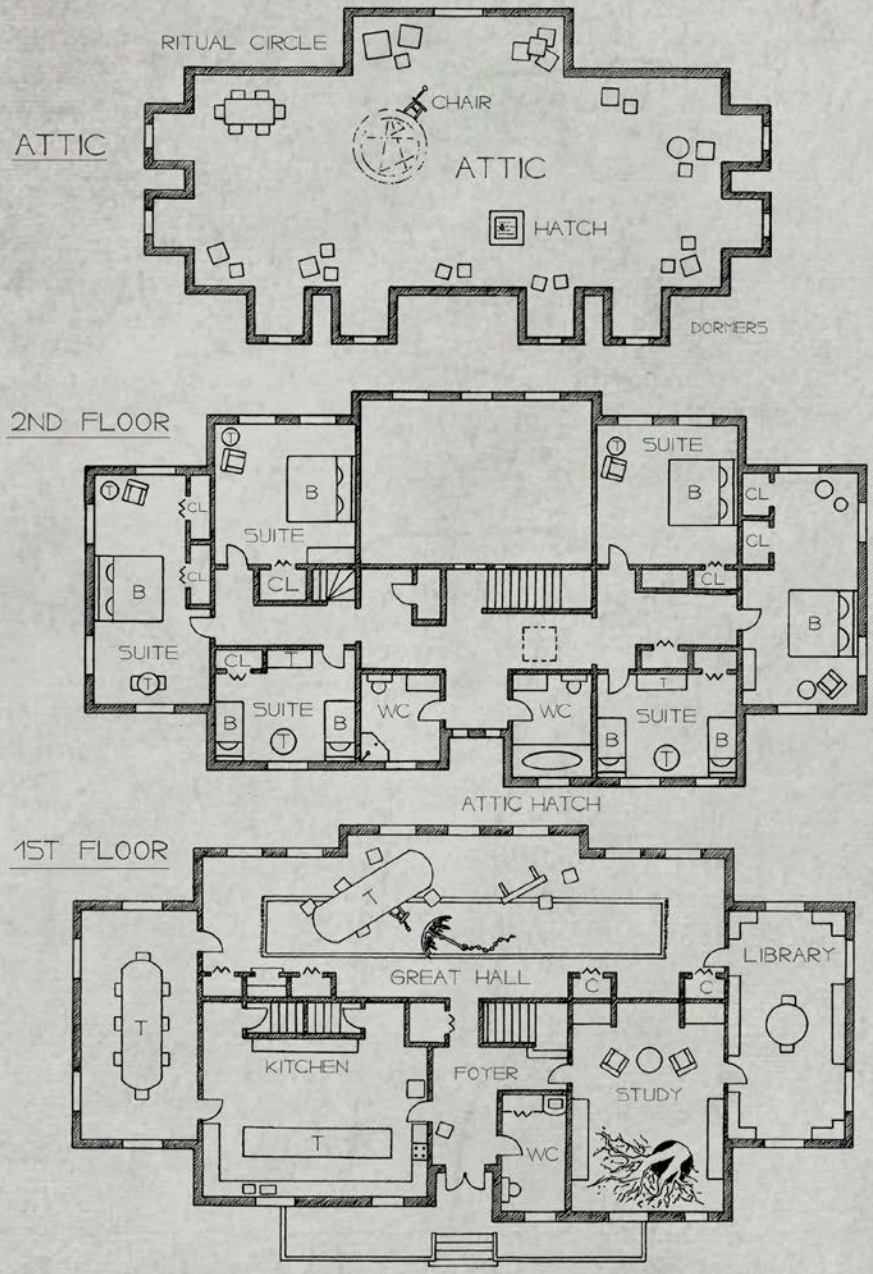
Anyone venturing out into the storm is immediately soaked, taking a Flaw on all Checks until they have a chance to dry off.

Great Hall

The first murders took place in the great hall, when Granny invited her guests down for a grand feast laced with arsenic. Many of the guests died before they were even able to leave the table.

Today, the table and chairs from that meal are all pushed up against the far wall of this two-story space, in a mess of broken furniture, cobwebs, and dust. The chandelier lies shattered on the floor, not too far away from a cold and empty fireplace. When the scene begins, this room is dark and chilly, with the storm winds blowing in through cracks between the boards covering the large windows.

HOLLYBROOK MAP





Lighting the Fireplace: Without setting up a lighting kit, the easiest way to illuminate the great hall is to build a fire in the fireplace. The broken chairs make for easy fuel, and an old box of matches on the mantel with three matches left inside provides the necessary spark. Lighting the fireplace takes a Harmless Luck Check, but each attempt uses one match.

Examining the Room: Once the space is lit, several ominous signs become visible. Beneath the grime and debris on the floor, police tape outlines of six bodies ring the space where the central table once stood, hinting at the scale of Granny's final feast. Dark splotches stain the hardwood floor around the heads of these figures. A Harmless Hard Perception Check or Harmless Occultism Check suggests that these stains were probably caused by the victims vomiting up blood, likely due to poison. Success also reveals that all these stains are very old, except for one near the fireplace that looks rather recent.

Falling Body: The body of the traveler from the Prologue remains here in the great hall, suspended by an old rotten rope in place of the room's ruined chandelier. The body falls to the floor just moments after the characters light the fireplace, landing with a dull thud and possibly striking any one character standing near the center of the room. This character must make a Risky Hard Evade Check to avoid being struck by the corpse, and anyone witnessing the grisly scene must attempt a Risky Courage Check to avoid being panicked by the sudden drop. **Add an Omen Die as a Flaw to the character making the Evade Check.**

The body's decomposition suggests that it has been dead for at least a week, and a Hard Perception Check reveals that the traveler was killed by blow to the back of the head.

Dark Shape: Small windows overlook the Hall from the stairway that leads up to the second floor. After the body has fallen, a character of your choice can attempt a Harmless Perception check to notice a dark figure receding away from the small, filthy windows.

Study and Library

The study and library are filled with bookshelves, dusty old paintings, and a surprising number of taxidermy birds. Due to the books, cobwebs, and creepy birds, this area would make for an ideal filming location for the *Ghost Stormers* crew.

Granny's Portrait: A painted portrait of Granny—the only image of her in the house—hangs above the fireplace in the study. During Act One, this portrait looks like an old, kindly woman with a slightly unhinged smile on her face. Anyone revisiting this painting in later Acts discovers that Granny has turned into a rotting corpse with a noose around her neck. The first character to spot this must succeed at a Hard Courage Check or flee in terror.

Room Contents: Built-in bookshelves line nearly every inch of the walls of the library, each stuffed with books on a variety of subjects. A Harmless Perception Check or Harmless Easy Occultism Check catalogs the books here as mostly focused on natural subjects concerning the Pacific Northwest, with a large focus on birds. An entire section of the library is dedicated to cookbooks, while other common subjects include human anatomy and toxicology. Notably, the study also has an old spirit board, meant to entertain guests.

Fireplace Remnants: The fireplace in the study contains a pile of ashes and debris that has blown in from the chimney over the years. A Very Hard Perception Check uncovers some burned old wallets and purses that once belonged to the guests who died here back in 2004. This check also uncovers a rusty old hammer.

Bird Fright: While the library features a few taxidermy birds tucked away on shelves and sitting on the end table, the study contains a large driftwood sculpture covered in birds. Characters in this room get the sense that the birds are watching them and possibly even moving whenever they aren't the focus of attention. Just as a character gets engrossed in another task here, one of these birds comes to life and swoops past them, raking them with its talons before flying out through one of the broken windows. The character must attempt a Risky Evade Check to avoid the bird or a Risky Very Hard Fight Check to bat it away. **Add an Omen Die to this Check as a Flaw.**

Kitchen & Dining Room

The kitchen and dining room take up the entire west wing of the first floor of the inn. In the dining room, dusty old sheets cover the antique furniture like lurking phantoms. Curtains of cobwebs obscure vision like clouds of fog. In the kitchen, where Granny prepared the poisoned meal that doomed her unfortunate guests, a gloomy malevolence lingers on, unsettling all who enter. A servant's stair leads up to the second floor, and beyond a locked door, another staircase descends to the basement.

Basement Door: The key to this solid oak door is attached to the bookmark in Granny's cookbook, found in the attic (see The Attic in Act Two). A Risky Very Hard Fight Check is sufficient to force open the door. Alternatively, the lock can be picked with a Very Hard Mechanics Check. Attempting to pick the lock without a set of lock picks incurs a Flaw on the Check.

Dining Room Haunt: The soiled dustcovers draped over the dining room table conceal a set of old dishes and tarnished silverware, set for a meal that was never

served. In Act Two or Three, the sheets covering the chairs surrounding the table also obscure ghostly figures, who all suddenly stand up and try to reach out and grab the first character who enters the room. Depending on how the character responds, this character might make a Courage, Evade, or Fight Check to escape this danger. After the Check, the dustcovers simply fall to the ground. There is nothing underneath.

The Cleaver: A massive, rusty meat cleaver lodged into the center of a table in the middle of the kitchen presents a fortuitous opportunity for the characters to pick up a weapon. Freeing the knife from the lump of rotten flesh and crumbling bone in which it is trapped requires a Risky Hard Fight Check.

Sinister Baking: When the characters first enter the kitchen, the old gas-burning stove suddenly flares to life, emitting a flickering yellow glow through its soot-stained window. Characters that approach can smell something baking, but they can't tell what it is without opening the oven. If a character opens the door, they see a golden crust pie baking on the center rack, with what looks like a human hand sticking out of the center. But before they can do anything else, the flames below suddenly surge into a blast of fire. The character that opened the oven must attempt a Risky Hard Evade Check to dodge the flames. **Add an Omen Die to this Check as a Flaw.**

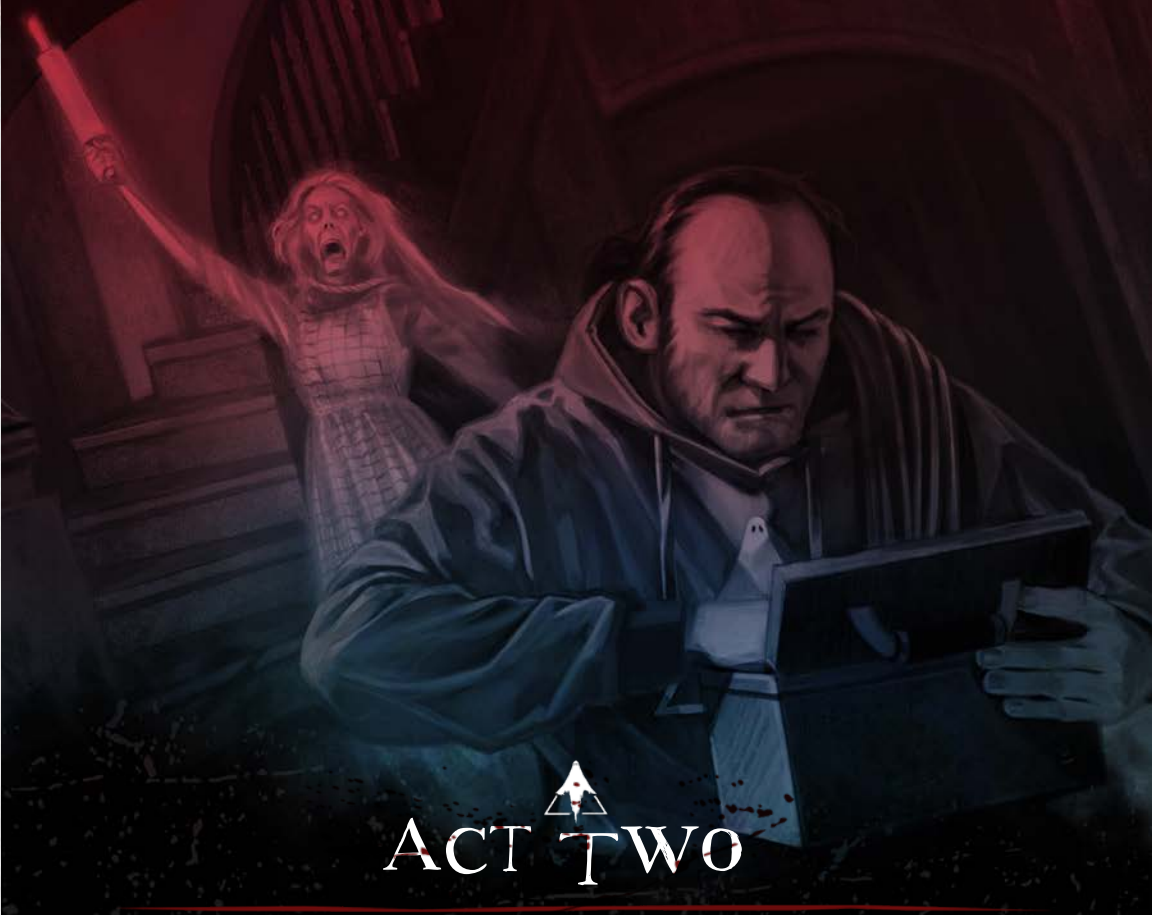
After the blast, the flames die out, and all that remains in the oven is a pile of cold ash.

Bedrooms

Upstairs consists of bedrooms for guests and Granny's personal room, the door to which is stuck shut until Act Two begins. The bedrooms differ in layout and contents, but they all tell the same gruesome tale. Many of the guests were locked in their rooms on that fateful night, only to be murdered by Granny later that evening. As such, each contains evidence of a violent scene, including ominous stains on the beds, ruined clothing, broken furniture, and dried blood sprayed on the wall. Granny killed most of her ill-fated guests with her rolling pin, but she couldn't resist using knives on those who left the most scathing reviews.

Searching the Bags: The slain guests' bags contain a wide variety of items one might pack for a weekend getaway (clothes, toiletries, first aid supplies, etc.). Characters searching these possessions for a specific item can find it with a Harmless Hard Luck Check.

Desperate Pleas: The first time a character is alone in one of the bedrooms, the door suddenly slams shut. Out of nowhere, the character can hear someone desperately pleading for their life. While this is happening, items fly through the air at dangerous speed, tossed by some invisible force. Let the character come up with a way to escape, but if they ask for options, you might suggest a Very Hard Fight Check to force open the door, a Hard Charm Check to convince the spirits that the character means no harm, or even a Risky Escape Check to climb out a window. Once the character escapes, the voices fade away. **The Host can add an Omen Die to any of these Checks as a Flaw.**



Act Two

Throughout Act One, the characters get a chance to know one another and explore the house, but by the end, it's clear that an oppressive malevolence resides in the Hollybrook Inn—and it's growing in strength. When Act Two begins, Granny fully manifests and attacks one of the characters with her deadly rolling pin.

Once this happens, the haunting truly begins. Ghostly events start to take place throughout the house, and Granny's waxing supernatural power seals the front door and all the windows, making it impossible for the characters to escape. As the characters continue to explore the house, two new locations become available to explore: the master suite, used by Granny as her personal chambers, and the attic, where Granny took her own life.

By the end of this Act, the characters will have learned that Granny was obsessed with the reviews of her critics and that she focused her rage upon the guest book, the record of all those who had disrespected her and brought ruin to her beloved Hollybrook. The characters will also have recovered a key to the basement and a few clues to indicate that the cursed book might be buried down there. With Granny's attacks becoming more dangerous, the characters have little time to solve this haunting before the Hollybrook becomes their tomb.

Structure

Act Two begins at any point once four Omen Dice are in play, either in the bag or in front of the characters. At this point, Granny manifests and attacks one of the characters. At the same time, the front door quietly closes (if it was not closed already) and locks, meaning that the characters can no longer leave the Hollybrook Inn. Also, the hatch to the attic and the door to Granny's room both open, allowing the exploration of those areas.

The characters are likely to start the second Act before completing all the scenes in the first. Those scenes can still take place in Act Two, adding more Omen Dice and giving Granny even more opportunities to menace the characters. Ghostly hauntings and other minor disturbances can now occur in any area of the Hollybrook, and they become more frequent as time goes on.

Reaching the attic is key to opening the way to Act Three and the conclusion of this story. There they will find Granny's cookbook and learn about her obsession. They will also get the key to the basement, giving them a slim chance of ending this haunting and possibly escaping with their lives.

Granny Attacks

To start Act Two, Granny waits until one character is by themself, perhaps as they are going to fetch some gear, use the restroom, or when they are forced to flee from something scary. At this point, the decrepit rotten ghost of Granny manifests and moves to attack the lone character.

As in life, Granny's shade wears a simple country dress underneath a frilled apron. A rustic shawl drapes her stooped shoulders, making her look older than she was when she died—about 60. Granny's ghost is a filthy, rotten echo of the woman she once was. Her yellowed teeth sharply contrast the deep, dark voids within her hollow eyesockets, pinpointed with tiny cold sparks of blue light. Her withered flesh flakes away, its texture equally as rough as her moth-eaten, stained clothes. Her form dissolves into shadow before reaching the ground, allowing her to glide completely silently if she wishes to do so.

As Granny approaches, ask the character to attempt a Very Hard Perception Check. If they succeed at this check, they spot Granny as she tries to sneak up on them and can decide how to avoid her attack. Possibilities include an Evade Check, a Hard Fight Check, or even a Very Hard Luck Check to stumble out of the way. If the character fails the Perception check, they don't get any warning until it's almost too late and must try a Risky Very Hard Evade check to avoid the blow. **In either case, add an Omen Die to the Check as a Flaw.** 

After Granny attacks, she quickly floats away, going upstairs as quickly as possible while avoiding other characters. Although Granny floats, the clomping sound of her shoes can be heard receding upstairs.

Ghostly Hauntings

Once Granny's ghost begins actively hunting the characters throughout the Inn, other minor hauntings and supernatural events



start to happen. The Host should feel free to invent their own hauntings or use the ones below as inspiration. These hauntings should be used whenever called for by the story to keep the tension high, but make sure to allow some small moments of calm so that the players aren't expecting danger with literally every decision they make for their characters.

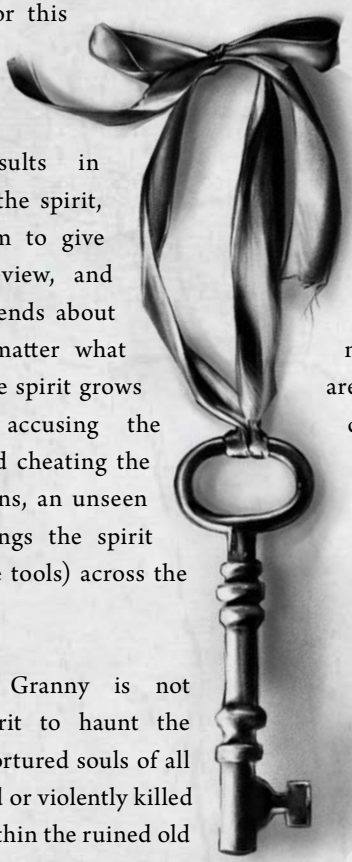
Cackling Cacophony: Starting off as a distant echo, the sound of a cackling laugh suddenly fills the room, growing in intensity until it drowns out all other sounds. Then, without warning, it cuts off and goes silent. No one in any other room hears the sound at all. Characters forced to endure the cackling take a Flaw on Checks while it persists.

Dark Transformation: Scattered throughout the house are several mirrors and panes of glass that cast a twisted reflection of the world around them. Select one character to spot something odd in one of these surfaces and ask them to attempt a Risky Easy Perception Check. No matter what the outcome, they see a twisted reflection of themself as a rotten corpse, with their head bashed in or their throat cut. Those that fail don't turn away before the reflection shatters, showering them with glass and giving them a Strain on Perception.

Flung Objects: Without warning, objects in the room begin to levitate from where they were resting and then fling themselves at one

character in the room. The character can attempt a variety of Risky Checks to attempt to dodge or fight back against the objects.

Malevolent Séance: Characters of an occult bent might attempt to use their esoteric knowledge to contact spirits haunting the inn, perhaps using the spirit board in the study for this purpose. Doing so requires a Risky Hard Occultism Check. Success results in making contact with the spirit, who kindly asks them to give the Hollybrook a review, and to please tell their friends about the experience. No matter what their responses are, the spirit grows distrustful, angrily accusing the characters of lying and cheating the system. As this happens, an unseen supernatural force flings the spirit board (or other séance tools) across the room in a broken heap.



Vengeful Spirits: Granny is not the only twisted spirit to haunt the Hollybrook Inn. The tortured souls of all the guests she poisoned or violently killed also remain trapped within the ruined old house. At any point, these spirits might take their frustration out on a character by moving objects away from them, causing minor mishaps, or even distracting them with gruesome hallucinations. Avoiding these spirits can result in a variety of Checks based on the situation or character in question.

Granny's Room

The door to this room is stuck shut until the start of Act Two, at which point it silently glides open just before Granny manifests to attack someone. In contrast to the relatively plain guest bedrooms, Granny's overwrought quarters are festooned with lace, flowing curtains, and old porcelain dolls. Everything here is old, dusty, and faded from years of neglect. The overpowering aroma of an old woman's stale perfume hangs heavy here, but underneath is the undeniable stench of rot.

Closet Inspection: The nearby closet is filled with old moldering dresses, many of which are falling off their hangers. The far closet contains more of the same, but in the back an old, dusty garment bag contains a vintage tuxedo with the name Theodore Pettywood on a 1954 dry cleaning receipt. The suit belonged to Granny's father, the man whose respect she was never able to earn. If anyone puts on the tuxedo, they get an Edge on any Checks made to interact with Granny, as the spirit hesitates in the face of unpleasant lingering memories. If they are still wearing the tuxedo in the basement, Granny sees through the ruse, and the character wearing it takes a Flaw on all Checks to interact with Granny due to her unbridled rage.

Trunk of Vendettas: A small metal trunk, its key long missing, is tucked under the bed. It can be opened with a Harmless Mechanics Check or a Very Hard Fight Check. Inside are hundreds of articles and newspaper clippings, all of which talk about the Hollybrook Inn and its owner, Emily Pettywood. While the oldest of these are complementary, the newer clippings are rather negative. By the end, some are clearly printed out from webpages, and these are the most damning of all. These latter reviews have angry scribblings all over them, mostly of figures being hanged or stabbed.

Dress Form Deception: Two old dress forms draped in dusty sheets stand in one corner of this room the first time a character enters. In truth, one of these shapes is actually Granny waiting to attack an unsuspecting character. As soon as someone turns their back on the dress forms, one of them moves forward to strike with a long, rusty pair of scissors. If the character mentions being wary or attempts to investigate the dress forms, they can choose the type of Check they make to avoid the attack. If not, they must attempt a Risky Hard Evade or Luck Check. **Add an Omen Die to the Check as a Flaw.** 

Granny vanishes the moment the attack is done.

The Attic

After killing all her guests, Granny retreated to the attic to await the end. She knew that some of her guests had managed to get out calls at the very end and that the police would soon arrive. Rather than face justice, she scrawled an oath to remain here forever to guard the honor and pride of Hollybrook. Then she hanged herself from the rafters.

The hatch to the attic is nailed shut from the inside and is impossible to open until Act Two. As there is no staircase or pull-down ladder, those wishing to get inside will need to improvise by either piling up beds and chairs, helping to lift each other up, or using some other piece of gear to make it easier to climb up. No matter what method is used, it likely calls for a Fight or Luck Check to avoid mishap.

The attic itself is cluttered with boxes filled with old mementos, spare linens and serving sets for the inn, and useless old junk. The piles of boxes are so high that they mostly obscure the dormer windows that look out over the grounds. In the center of the attic is an open space where Granny scribed her oath in rune-like symbols. In the center of this sits her cookbook. The cut remnant of the rope that sealed Granny's fate dangles from the ceiling, immediately above the cookbook.

Searching Boxes: Characters might try to search through the boxes up here to see if they can uncover anything useful for their current situation, but there's little to help them. Photo albums show the Hollybrook Inn throughout the years, charting its fall into disrepair. They also show Emily's slow decline from a vibrant middle-aged woman to the embittered person she became. There are a few simple tools and a handsaw stashed away here, but finding them requires a Very Hard Luck Check.

Ritual Circle: Granny carved her ritual circle into the wooden floor with her own bloody fingernails. Her beloved cookbook rests at the center of the circle of runes, not far from a kicked-over chair and directly underneath a short length of rope tied to one of the rafters above. When the police finally arrived at the inn, this is where they found Granny, having hanged herself here in the attic, but not before she swore to watch over this place for all eternity.

Anyone studying the runes can attempt a Very Hard Occultism Check to learn that they are meant to bind the soul to a place. Inside this circle, Granny scratched her vow, promising to forever guard this site and to take terrible vengeance on those who wronged her and brought shame to her family name.

Crossing the edge of the circle is difficult, as if some invisible force is pushing back against any attempt. To do so a character must attempt a Risky Hard Courage Check or a Risky Very Hard Fight Check. The character crosses in either case, but they might find themself Strained (or worse) due to the attempt.

The Cookbook: In the center of the circle is Granny's cookbook, a handmade journal containing her recipes, thoughts, and unhinged ravings. What first starts out as a treasure trove of old family recipes slowly devolves into a manifesto of imagined slights and growing grudges. This descent begins with just a few comments about slowing reservations and notes about rude guests in the margins, but going deeper into the book, it becomes less about recipes and focuses more on how amateur reviewers are ruining her family name and that it all must be some sort of conspiracy. By the end, the only recipes in the book are for poisoned dishes interspersed with aspirational ravings about how Granny plans to properly torture her guests before killing them.

All of this can be learned with a relatively quick perusal of the book and by making a Perception Check. Of special note, the last page of the cookbook reads, "The time is finally here. I've called all of them from the guest book, all of them that deserve to suffer. Tonight will be their final meal, and then I'll bury that cursed book for good." There is a bookmark placed on that final entry, and tied to the bottom of it is the key to the basement door (see the Kitchen scene on page 49).

Granny's Rage: The moment Granny's cookbook is removed from the circle, her ghost appears and attacks with her rolling pin, screaming at the characters for defiling her sacred space. The most likely way to avoid her rage is with a Risky Hard Evade Check. **This should certainly have an Omen Die added as a Flaw to the Check.** After this, Granny vanishes but continues to assault the players until they flee the attic by knocking over piles of boxes, flinging the taxidermy head of an eight-point buck, and causing a whirlwind of razor-sharp antlers. **The Host is encouraged to add additional Checks (and additional Omen Dice if any remain in Act Two) to make the escape from the attic a harrowing moment in the story.**



Act Three

With the storm raging outside and Granny's hatred reaching its peak inside, the characters find themselves trapped within a nightmare. The spirits of the dead begin to appear throughout the house, while Granny stalks them from the darkness. With the cookbook in hand, the *Ghost Stormers* crew finally has the clue they need to bring an end to this haunting, and it involves the inn's missing guest book.

But first, they must find it. Although there were many steps Granny took in the journey from innkeeper to murderer, the first step was her obsession over the reviews found in the guest book. She spent months poring over them. Whenever a customer left a new review, she would read it that same day. Her obsession turned to hatred, and when she finally began planning her murderous rampage, Granny used the guest book to select her victims. The day before they arrived, Granny took the book to the basement and buried it to ensure that no one ever left her a bad review ever again.

The guest book is the focal point of the haunting. If the characters want to escape, they'll need dig up the book and use it to put Granny's tortured spirit to rest. This act features a desperate race down to the basement, frantic digging as they attempt to find the book, and finally, deciding how to end the terror of the Hollybrook Inn.

Structure

Act Three begins shortly after the characters remove the cookbook from the attic. It's at this point that all the tortured souls who died in the inn begin to appear and menace the characters. Any scenes from previous Acts can still be explored, with the addition of ghosts that now roam the building and Granny's continuing rampage.

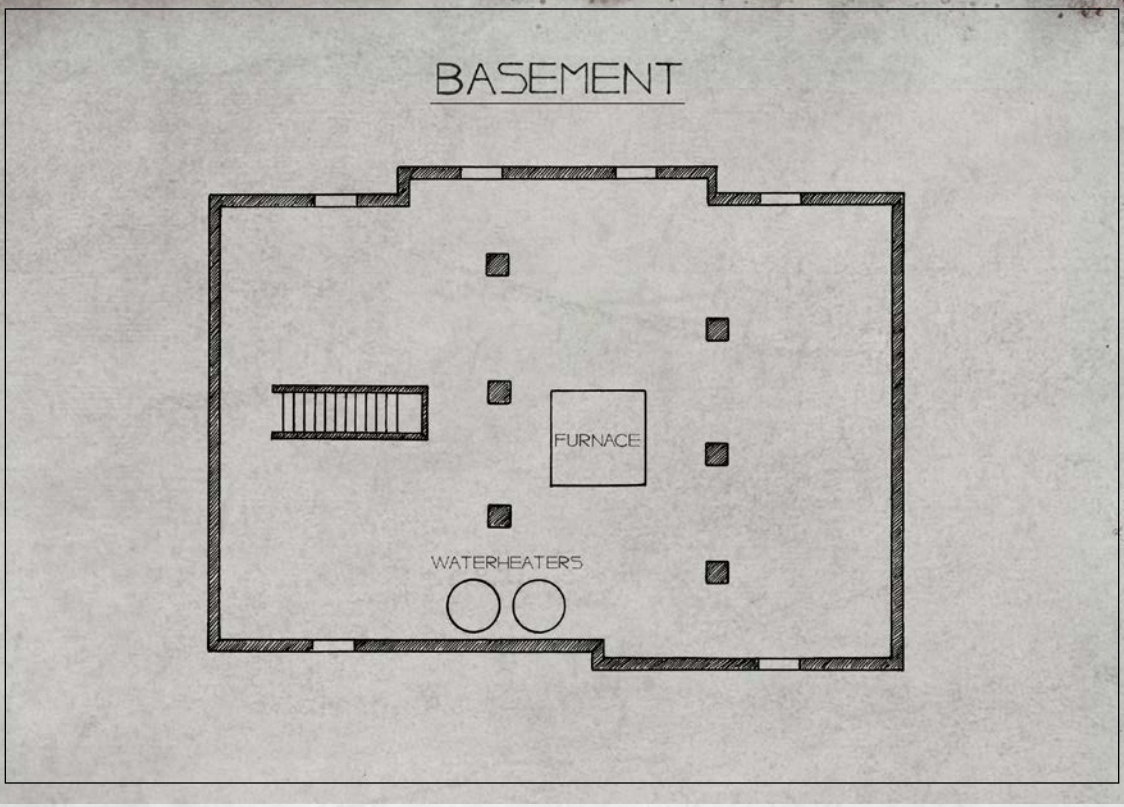


Act Three presents only two additional scenes. The first occurs just about everywhere in the house, involving the spirits of the dead whose torment drives them to menace the characters. The second is the basement, where the guest book is buried. It is here, in the dark, that Granny's rage reaches its peak. Once the characters have the book, they can bring this nightmare to an end in several ways.

Echoes of the Massacre

Act Three starts when the characters remove Granny's cookbook from the attic. At this moment, dozens of ghosts suddenly manifest, each one reliving the last moments of their life. One of these ghosts approaches the characters, begging and pleading to be let free, promising to leave a better review, desperate to get out of this cursed place. Pick one character to respond to the ghost with a Hard Charm Check or some other appropriate Check based on how they try to calm the spirit. **Add the first Omen Die of Act Three to this Check as a Flaw.** If the Check is successful, the ghost thanks the character before fading away, but if they fail, it follows them until they reach the basement, demanding help and drawing the attention of other ghosts.

During this Act, the ghosts are a constant menace to the characters until they reach the basement. This can take many forms (as noted below), but generally takes place no more than once per scene. If the characters go straight to the basement, a single ghost



follows them as they approach the door. Add an additional ghost encounter if the character didn't manage to calm the initial spirit. These encounters should be used to keep the tension high as the characters desperately try to get to the basement, but they should not contribute more than one Omen Die to play, with the rest being reserved for the Basement scene.

Dying Spirits: The characters encounter a group of ghosts dying from poison, stumbling about the room, clawing at their throats, reaching out in desperation for any form of aid. One character becomes the target of their pleas, requiring a Charm Check to move past them unharmed or an Occultism Check to try to convince them that they are now at peace.

Ghostly Rage: The ghost flings a large object at one of the characters, such as an overstuffed chair, a dusty painting, or a rotting taxidermy animal, requiring a Risky Evade Check to leap out of the way.

Granny's Vengeance: A ghost comes crawling into the room just before Granny appears to bash their head in with her rolling pin. This violent scene is more than enough to test the Courage of one of the characters.

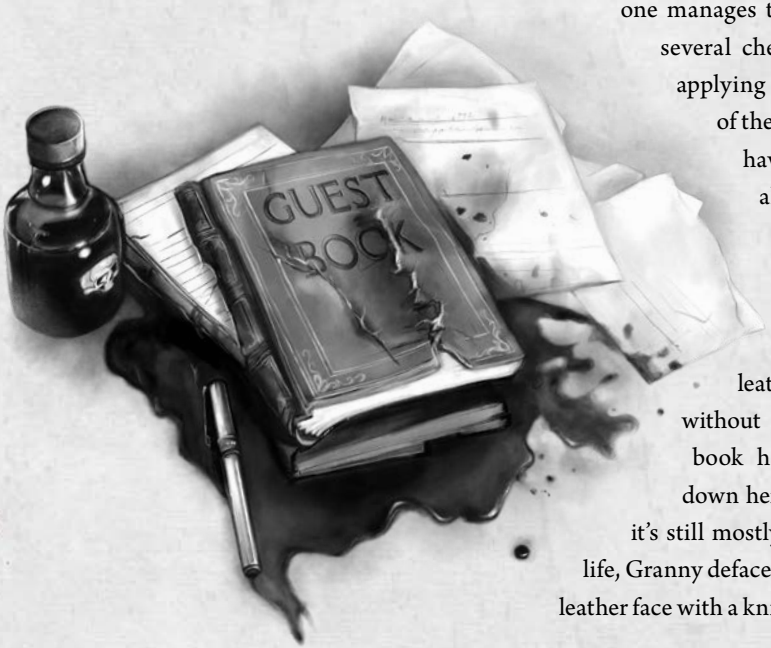
Whirlwind: The ghosts in this area violently try to break out, smashing everything in the room and causing a whirlwind of broken debris to fly around. Getting through unscathed calls for a Risky Hard Luck Check or a Risky Very Hard Evade Check.

The Basement

The Hollybrook Inn's unfinished basement is accessible only through the locked door in the kitchen. The key to this door is attached to the cloth bookmark found inside Granny's cookbook. Curious characters might have gotten access to the basement before Act Three, but nothing happens down here until the cookbook is found, and any attempt to dig up the floor before this Act uncovers nothing of interest.

Description: Beyond the door is an old set of worn, creaky wooden stairs that lead down into an unfinished, earthen-floored basement. The walls of this place are ancient fieldstones, laid down when the building was first constructed back in 1897. The darkened room contains no source of light other than the occasional flash of lightning from the storm outside, which briefly illuminates the space from the tiny basement windows. In the center of the basement rests an old, rusted coal furnace that has not been lit in over 20 years. Dozens of pipes lead out from it, making it look like a giant rusty spider perched in the center of the space. Off to one side is a pair of more modern-looking water heaters. Other than that, the basement is almost entirely empty.

Digging up the Book: The book could be buried literally anywhere within the large basement. Characters can attempt to locate it by making a Very Hard Luck Check with a Flaw due to the room's size. In addition, anyone without a proper digging tool takes another Flaw on this Check. There is a single rusty shovel hidden under the stairs, but it can only be found with a Hard Perception check. All Checks made down here take a Flaw if the characters don't have enough light. If no one manages to dig up the book after several checks, the Host can stop applying the Flaw due to the size of the basement (because they have searched so much of it already).



Once a character makes this Luck Check, they dig up the old leather-bound guest book without too much trouble. The book hasn't fared well, buried down here for all these years, but it's still mostly intact. It's clear that in life, Granny defaced the book, carving up its leather face with a knife.

Fury of Granny: The moment the characters start digging up the floor, the environment around them begins to change. Bloody letters begin to appear on the walls of the basement, spelling out damning reviews of the Hollybrook and Granny's hospitality. At the same time, the furnace flares to life and thick smoke begins to fill the space. This is not dangerous at first, but it does quickly make it hard to see more than about 10 feet in the cramped, filthy space.

Moments later, Granny appears, rising out of the ground to attack the characters while they continue to dig. Ask the players which characters are digging and which ones are trying to keep Granny at bay. Others might have other tasks they are trying to accomplish as well, like looking for a shovel or preparing to destroy the book.

The nature of Granny's attacks is up to the Host to decide, but they most certainly involve thrown knives and her deadly rolling pin. **These should be relentless now. Most Checks should be Risky and have an Omen Die added to the Check as a Flaw.** The Host should hold one Omen Die in reserve for the final Check to destroy the book (or otherwise end the haunting).

The Guest Book

Once the characters make the Luck check to find the missing guest book, they can finally bring this haunting to a close. There are two simple ways to end this story, but clever players may invent another way that their characters might deal with the book and banish Granny, allowing them to escape. The Host should consider these ideas if it would make for a good end to the story, invent one final Check to see if they succeed.

Destroying the Book: Depending on the gear at hand, the characters might simply try to destroy the book. It resists most forms of physical destruction, but it can be burned. Getting it to light requires one final Risky Hard Luck Check if the characters use their own source of fire. Alternatively, they could wrench open the door to the furnace and throw the book inside. Getting it open requires a Risky Hard Fight Check. Characters with something to protect their hands from the scorching-hot furnace get an Edge on this Check.

Ending the Cycle: Instead of destroying the book, the characters might try to leave a good review to calm Granny and allow themselves to escape. This requires one character to attempt a Very Hard Charm Check. If they succeed, Granny stops in her tracks and looks at them with tears in her eyes before fading away. If they fail, she calls them liars and charlatans. Leaving a good review can only be attempted once.

Granny's Retribution: Each attempt to bring this to an end immediately draws Granny's ire to that character. Should they fail, Granny knocks the book out of their hands, forcing someone else to pick it up and try again. **Any Omen Dice that remain in front of the Host should be added to these Checks, one at a time.**

Conclusion

After a long night of terror and supernatural attacks, it's likely that some of the characters didn't survive the ordeal. **If all the characters perished** during the events of this story, the Host should read or paraphrase the following to bring this tale to a close.

As the last of you falls into darkness, the voice of Granny can be heard cackling in the distance. "Yes," she says, "I do hope you will enjoy your stay. Let me know what you think of the accommodations. I'm always open to feedback." As the light fades from the world, you find yourselves anchored to this place, forced to endure Granny's hospitality, untethered from your body, reliving the nightmare of the past evening over and over again. Your only hope is that one day, some others may come here and put an end to this haunting, so that you might finally be free.



If instead the characters manage to find and deal with the guest book, the nightmare at Hollybrook finally draws to a close, allowing any survivors to escape. If they destroy the book, the spirit of Granny cries out in anguish before fading away like smoke dissipating in the breeze. If they mollify her with a good review, she gently fades from view, tears welling up in her long-dead eyes. At the same time, all the other ghosts and hauntings happening upstairs in the rest of the house come to an end. The ghosts there are finally free to leave this place, and the house itself returns to its rotten and ruined state.

The Host should read or paraphrase the following to the players, adjusting any details as necessary to match the ending of the story.

The house grows silent as Granny fades from view. The ghosts that have been trapped here for years are finally free. The building itself lets out an ominous, settling groan, as if finally able to relax from decades of stress. Climbing up from the basement, it's clear that the storm outside has abated. The front door to the Hollybrook Inn has swung open, allowing a cool breeze to blow inside.

For years this place festered, poisoned by Granny's hate and her obsession with vengeance, but now it just looks old and on the verge of collapse.

Perhaps that is for the best. The Hollybrook should be forgotten, along with the dark deeds that happened here. Loading up into the van, the future of this place is uncertain, but for the Ghost Stormers, only one thing is clear. The Haunting of Hollybrook is going to be your best episode ever!

Six Months Later…

Shining silver scissors slice through the thick red ribbon strung across the entrance of the newly remodeled Hollybrook Inn. A round of gentle applause rises up from the small crowd of guests and influencers invited to the grand reopening.

A smile crosses the lips of the inn's new owner, Mr. Ashford. The retired broker had spent a small fortune getting this place ready for the summer season, and he was pleased by the turnout.

Of course, he had to cut a few corners to get the place ready in time. The west facade was still unpainted, some of the doors still creak, and the attic had a peculiar smell that he just could not seem to eliminate. The place was far from perfect, but it didn't matter.

These guests were more interested in getting a free weekend than they were in giving an honest assessment, and if one of them gave a middling review, what possible harm could that cause? As he invited them all inside, he made sure to point out the guest book sitting in the foyer.

Up above, a dark shape watches them from an attic window. Watches and waits.

Continuing the Story

This is surely not the end of the *Ghost Stormers* story, and many other 13 Omens tales can easily be adopted to be another one of their investigations. If Granny was not put to rest, this place continues to be a haunted menace to any who dare to venture inside. Even if Granny was appeased for now, her spirit may still linger, waiting to prey upon anyone else unfortunate enough to stumble into the Hollybrook.

In addition, the Hollybrook Inn is not the only business that Granny owned. There are rumors that she owned several mountain cabins in the nearby Oregon Coast Range, although according to records, they closed just one month after opening, under suspicious circumstances. Perhaps this is the next *Ghost Stormers* case!



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